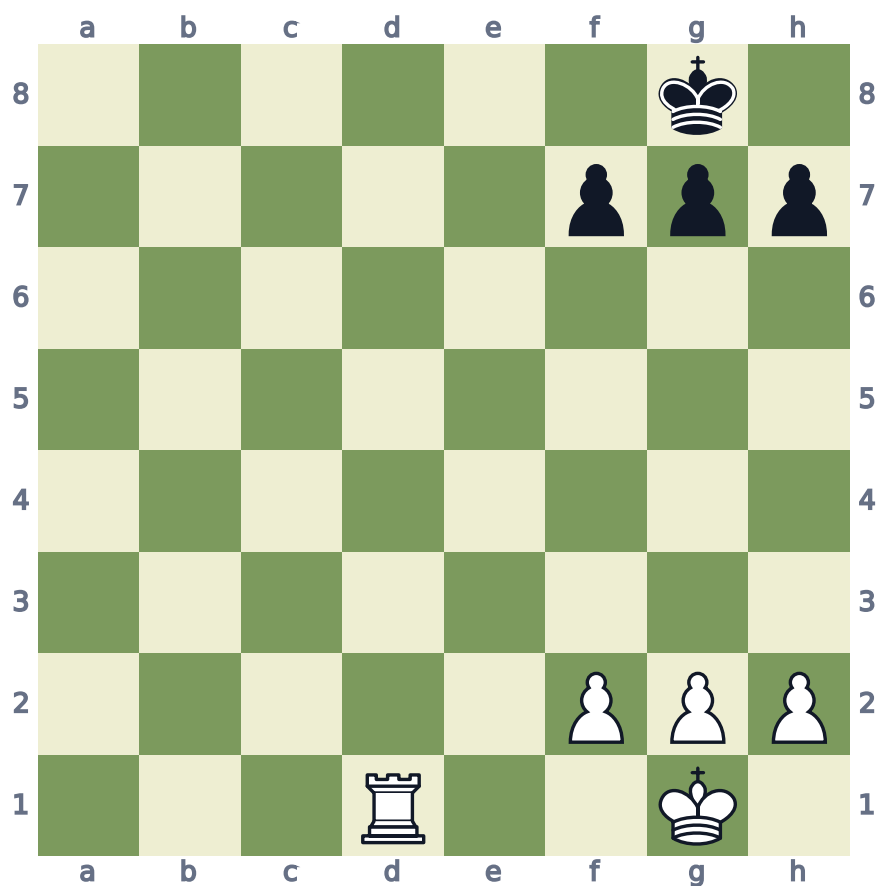


Checkmate Pattern Atlas

The geometry of mating nets, learned from both sides



Train the recurring mating pictures that strong players recognize instantly, while learning the escape-square and defender logic that makes each pattern work.

24 practice units | separated solutions | scoring | review plan

ORIENTATION

How to get real improvement from this course

PURPOSE

Train the recurring mating pictures that strong players recognize instantly, while learning the escape-square and defender logic that makes each pattern work.

TRAINING RULES

- For every mating move, name the checking line, every flight square, and every defender that cannot intervene.
- Solve the reversed-color partner immediately afterward so the picture is not tied to one orientation.
- After finding mate, remove one supporting piece and explain exactly why the mate fails.
- Rebuild missed patterns on a physical board or in Fritz from the FEN companion file.

COURSE SIZE

This PDF contains 24 practice units. Problems appear before their solutions whenever practical. Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days.

SCORING

What a complete answer contains

RECOGNITION

Name the tactical or strategic feature without assuming that the familiar pattern works.

CANDIDATES

List serious forcing and improving choices before analyzing deeply.

BEST RESISTANCE

Calculate the opponent's least cooperative legal response.

ENDPOINT

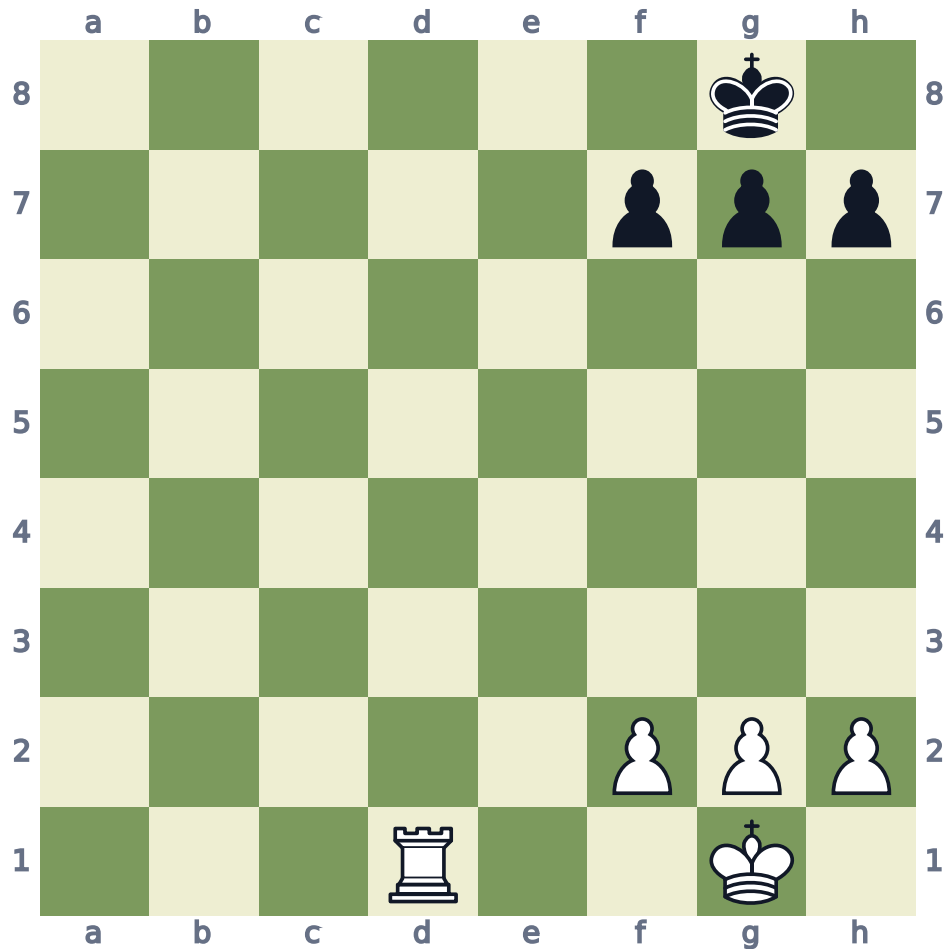
Stop only after forcing play settles, then evaluate material, kings, activity, and structure.

TRANSFER

State the visible cue that should make you remember this position during a game.

PROBLEM 01 OF 24

Back-rank mate



YOUR TASK

White to move. Find checkmate in one and name every escape square that is controlled or occupied.

DIFFICULTY

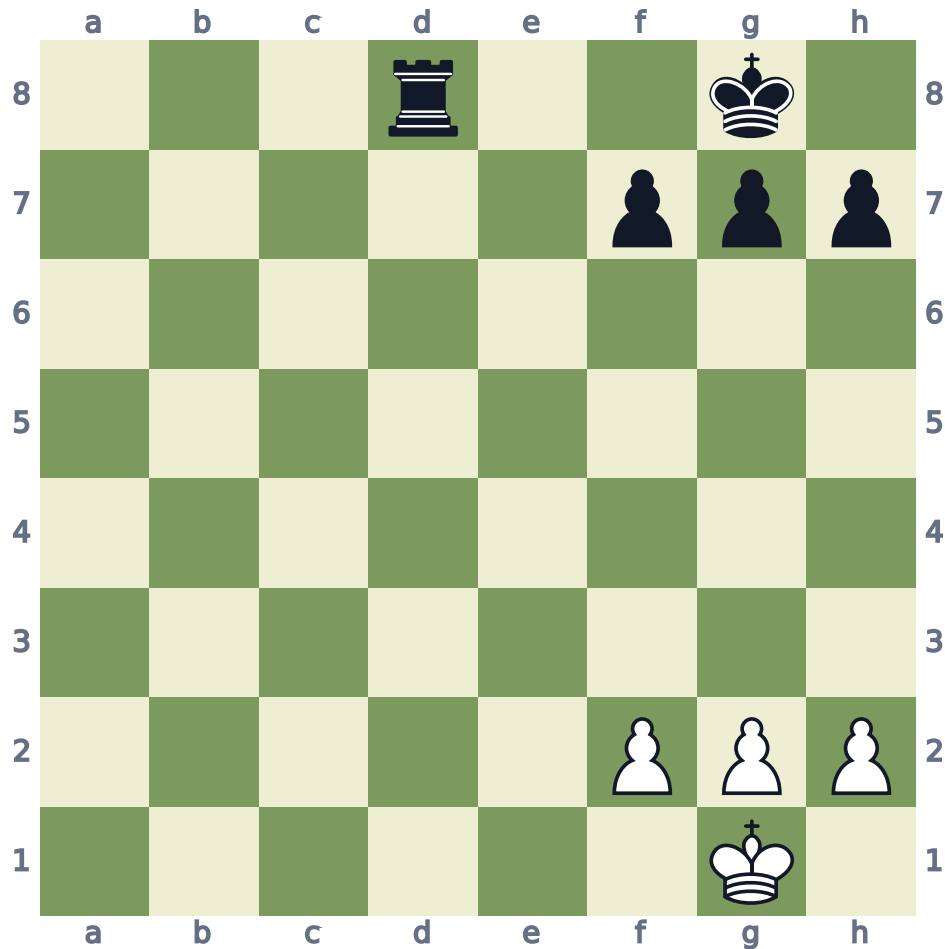
Foundation

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 02 OF 24

Back-rank mate - reversed colors



YOUR TASK

Black to move. Find checkmate in one. Explain the same geometry from the opposite orientation.

DIFFICULTY

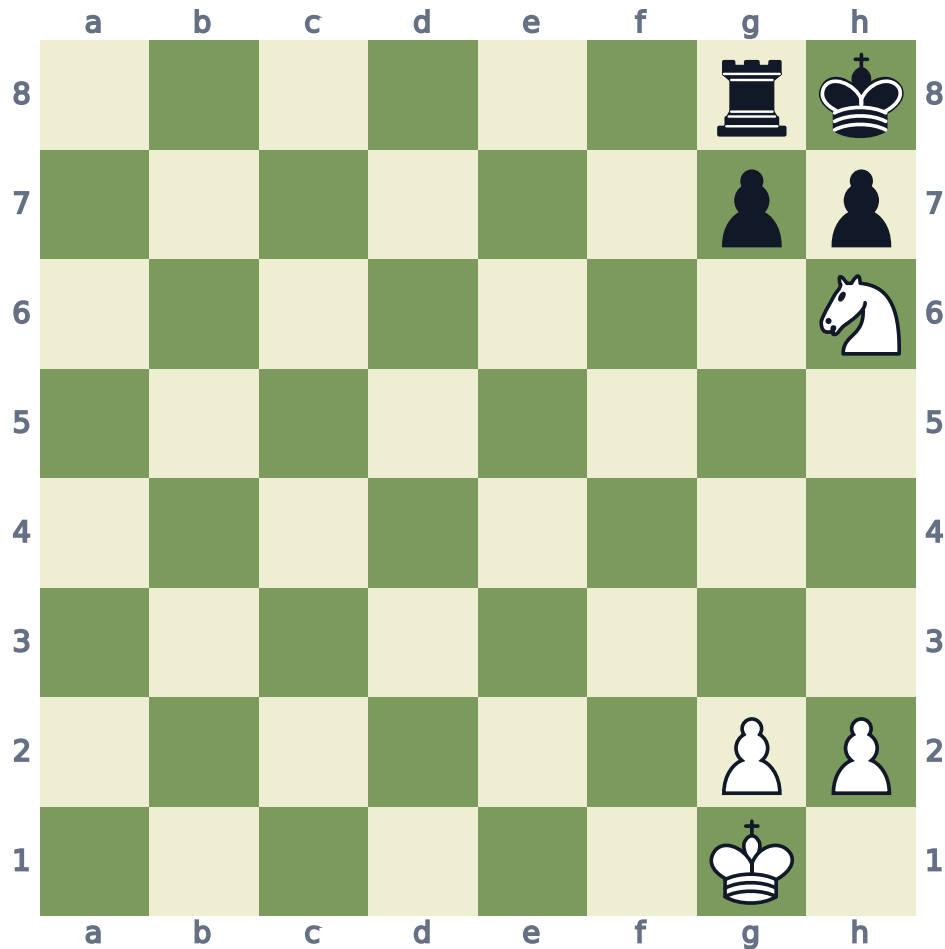
Foundation - reverse view

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 03 OF 24

Smothered mate



YOUR TASK

White to move. Find checkmate in one and name every escape square that is controlled or occupied.

DIFFICULTY

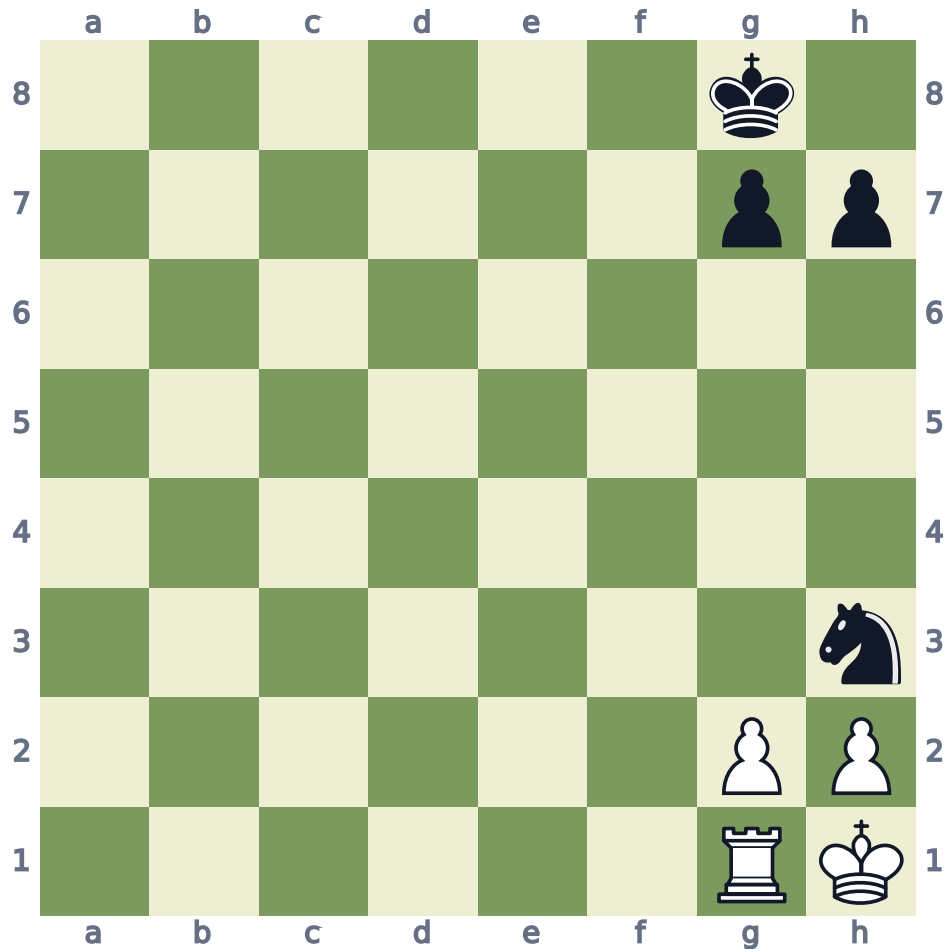
Foundation

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 04 OF 24

Smothered mate - reversed colors



YOUR TASK

Black to move. Find checkmate in one. Explain the same geometry from the opposite orientation.

DIFFICULTY

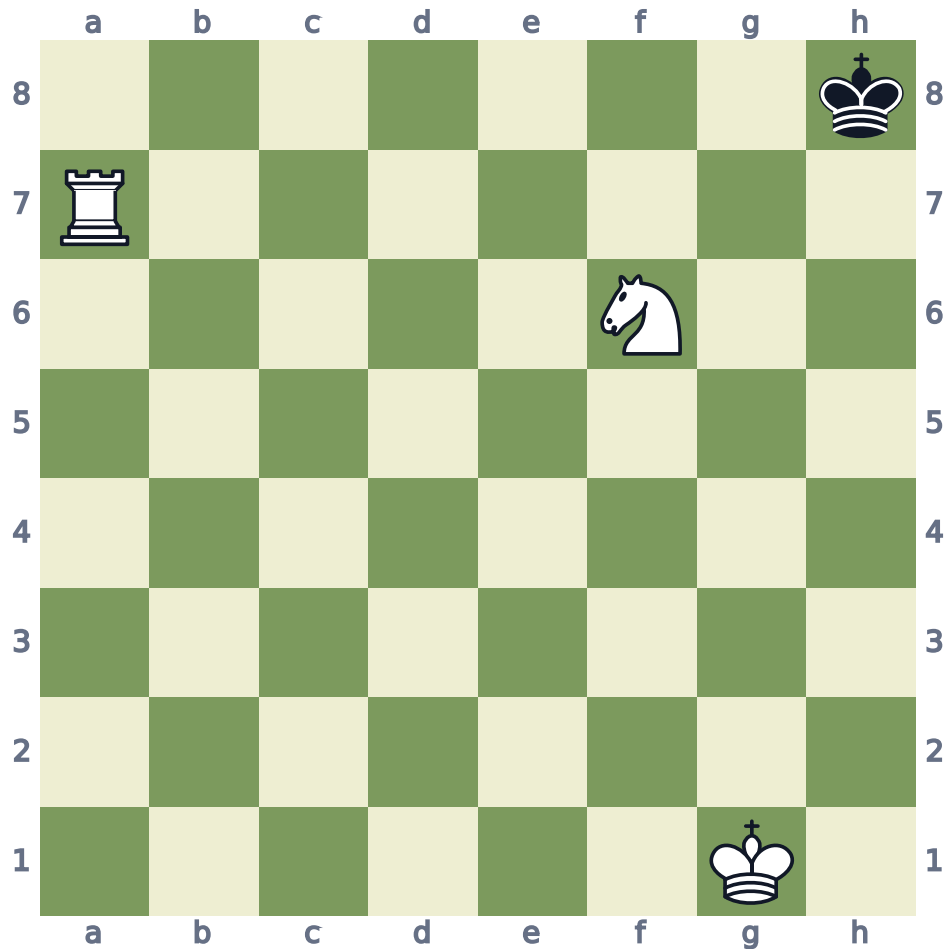
Foundation - reverse view

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 05 OF 24

Arabic mate

**YOUR TASK**

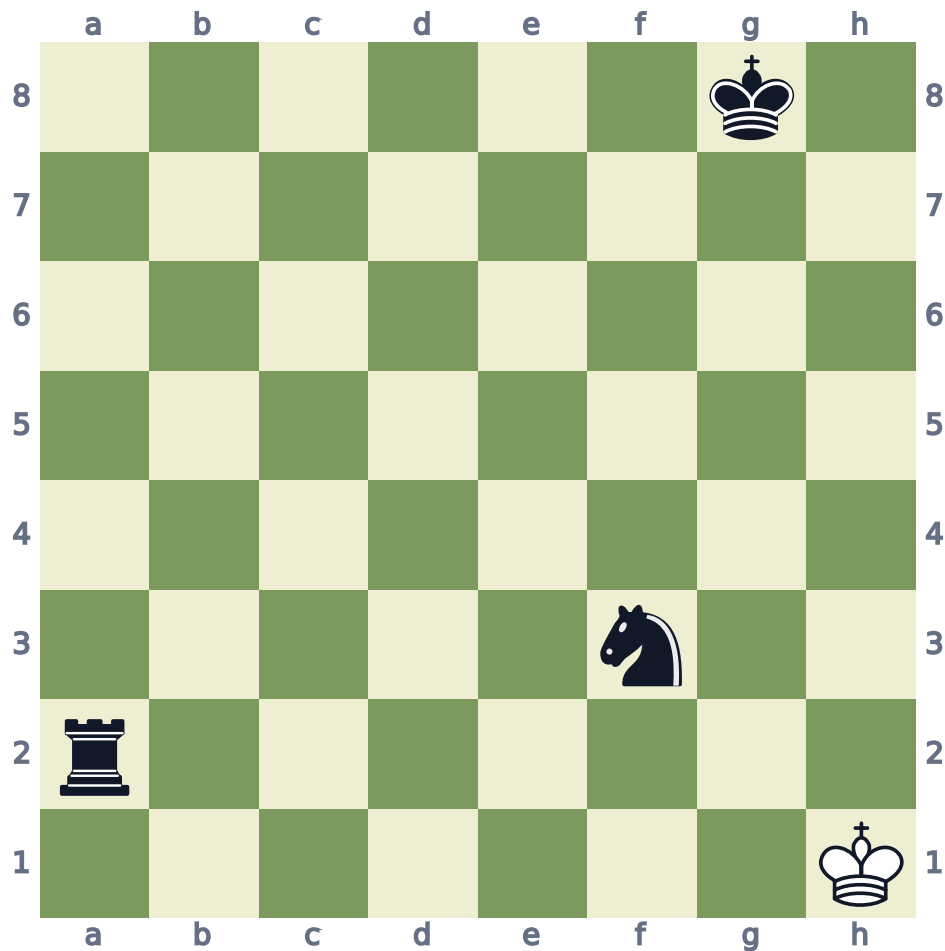
White to move. Find checkmate in one and name every escape square that is controlled or occupied.

DIFFICULTY**Foundation****BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION**

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 06 OF 24

Arabian mate - reversed colors



YOUR TASK

Black to move. Find checkmate in one. Explain the same geometry from the opposite orientation.

DIFFICULTY

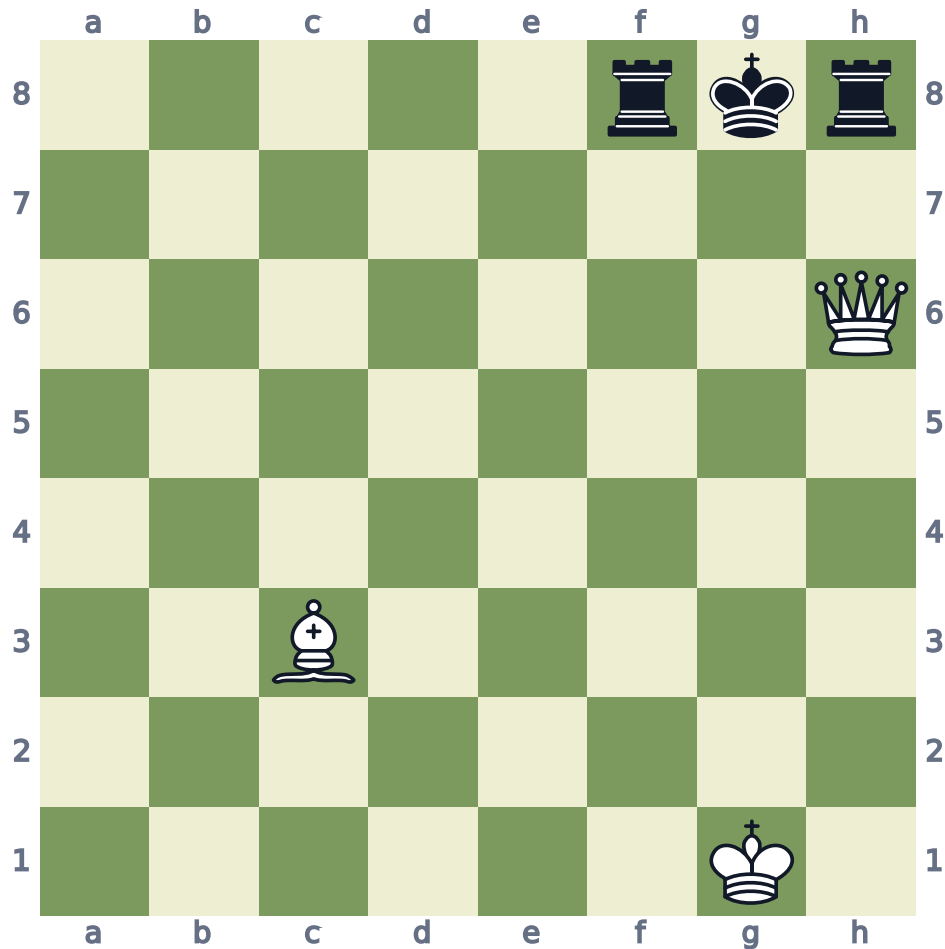
Foundation - reverse view

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 07 OF 24

Epaulette mate



YOUR TASK

White to move. Find checkmate in one and name every escape square that is controlled or occupied.

DIFFICULTY

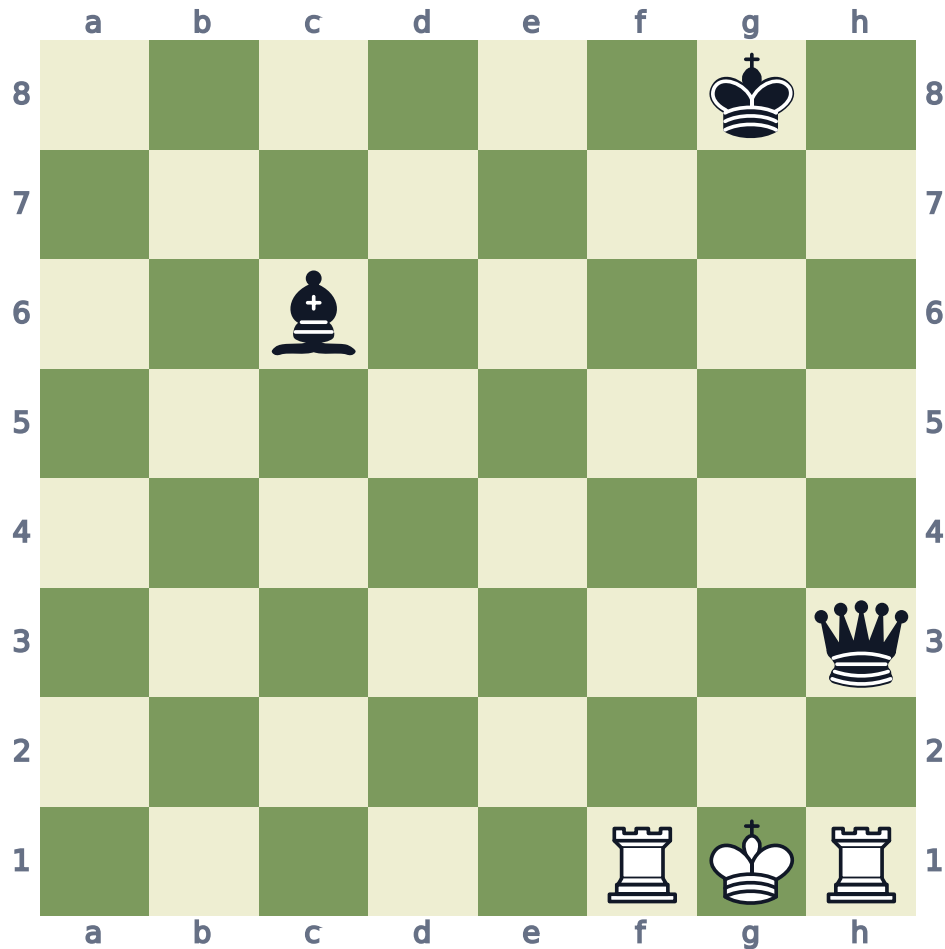
Foundation

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 08 OF 24

Epaulette mate - reversed colors



YOUR TASK

Black to move. Find checkmate in one. Explain the same geometry from the opposite orientation.

DIFFICULTY

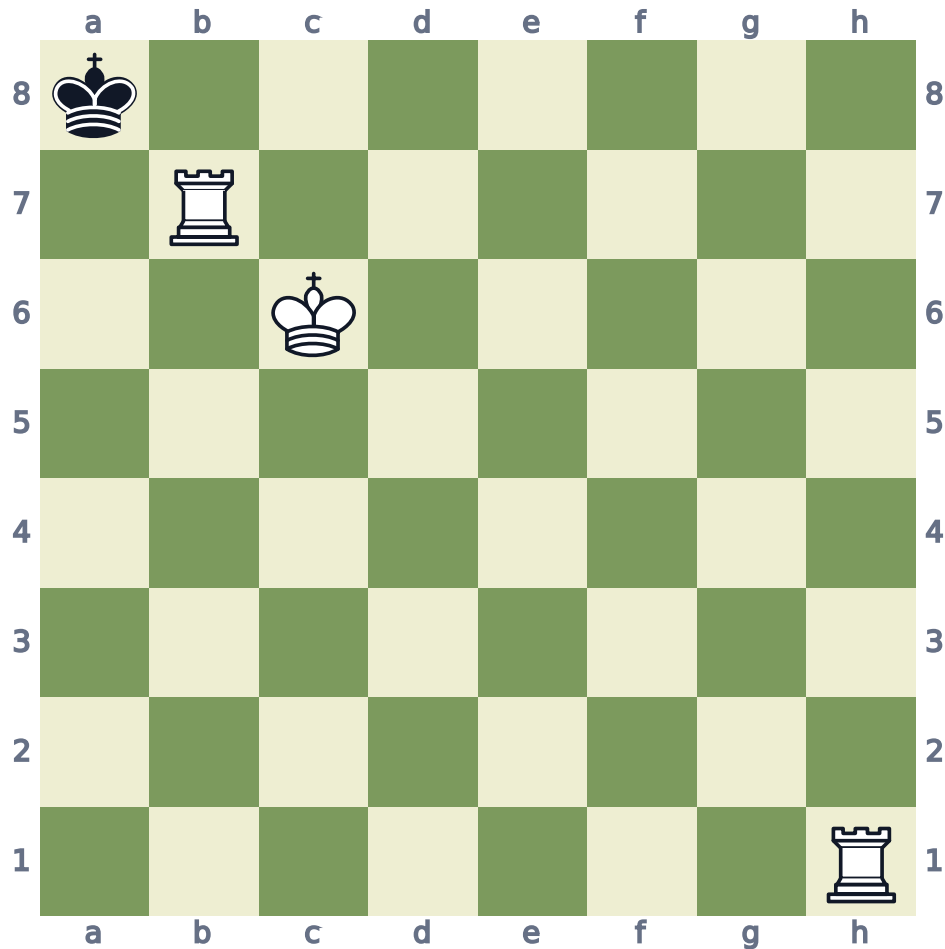
Foundation - reverse view

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 09 OF 24

Ladder mate

**YOUR TASK**

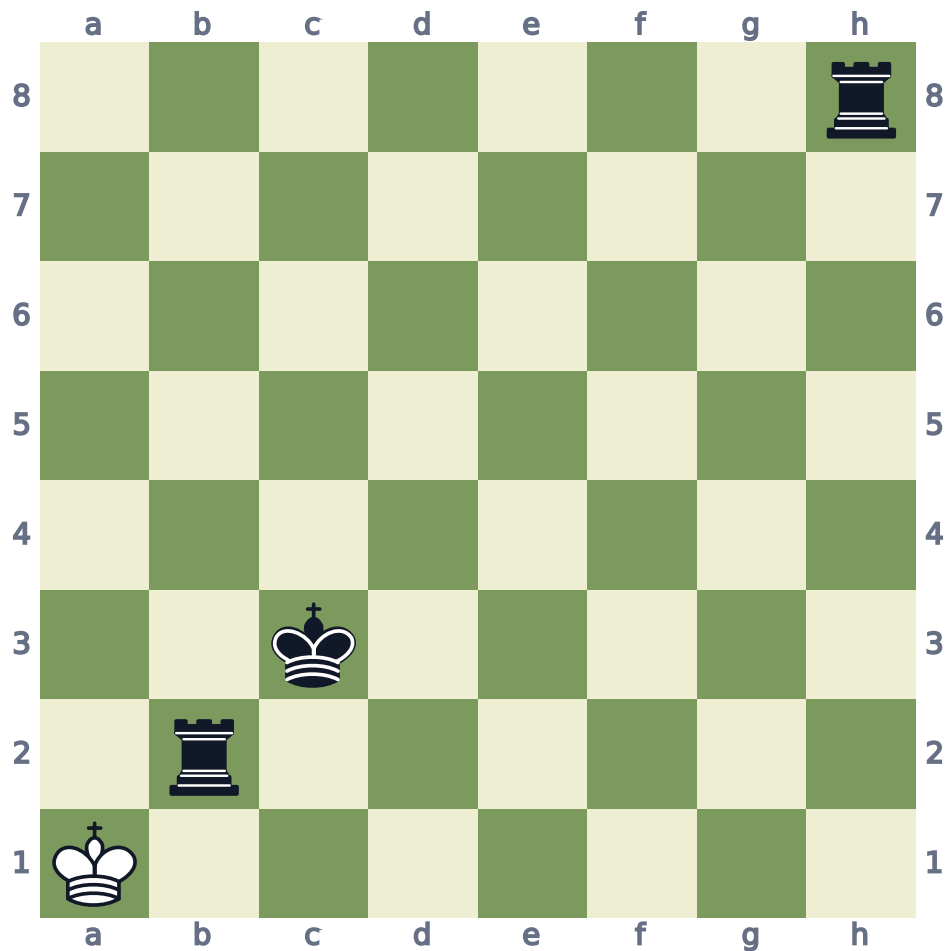
White to move. Find checkmate in one and name every escape square that is controlled or occupied.

DIFFICULTY**Foundation****BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION**

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 10 OF 24

Ladder mate - reversed colors



YOUR TASK

Black to move. Find checkmate in one. Explain the same geometry from the opposite orientation.

DIFFICULTY

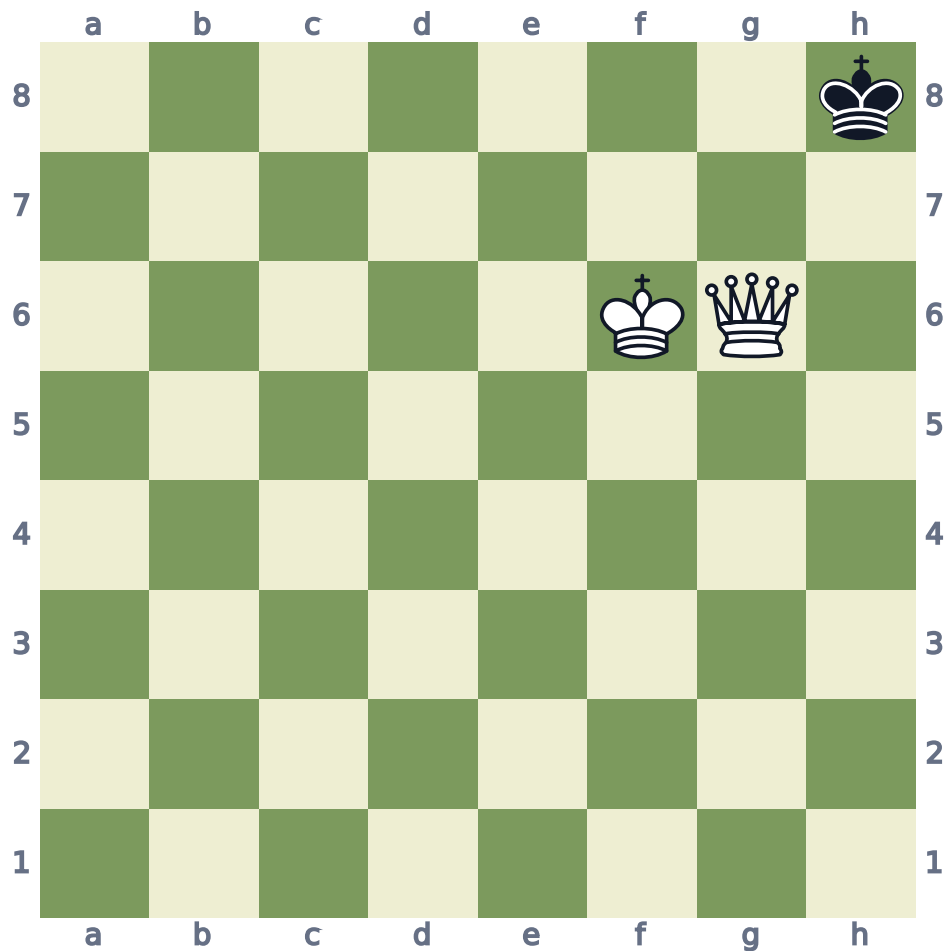
Foundation - reverse view

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 11 OF 24

Queen box mate



YOUR TASK

White to move. Find checkmate in one and name every escape square that is controlled or occupied.

DIFFICULTY

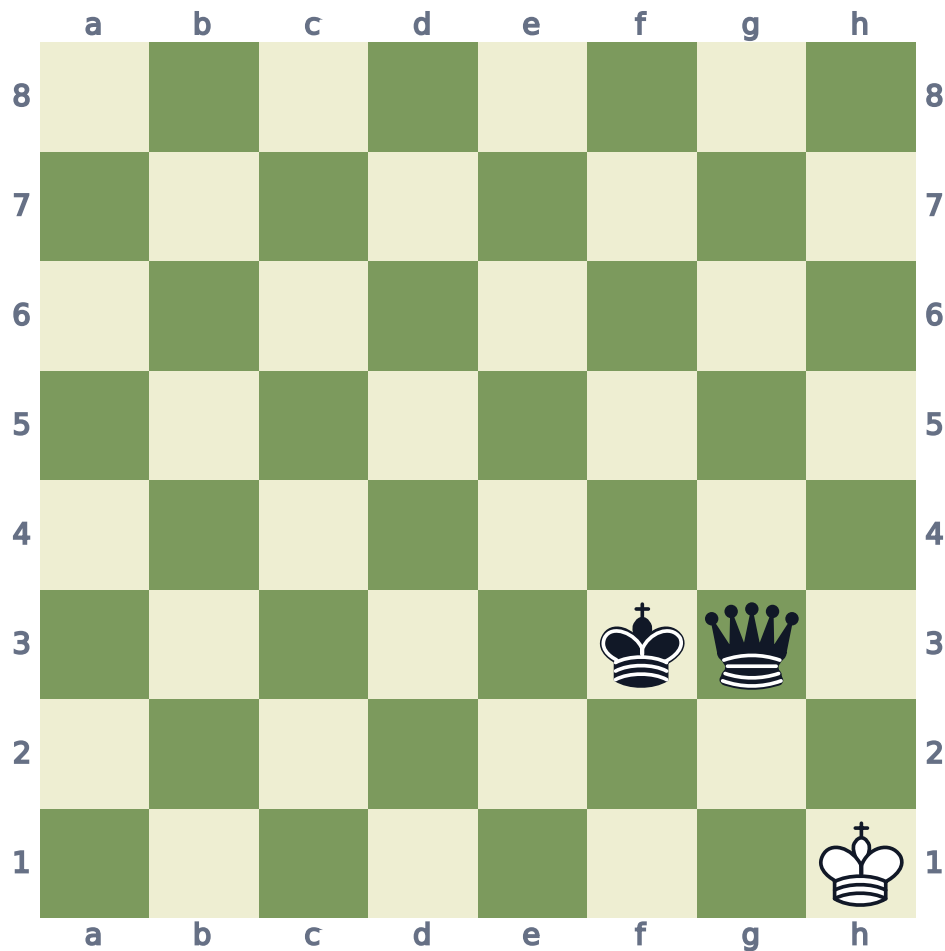
Foundation

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 12 OF 24

Queen box mate - reversed colors



YOUR TASK

Black to move. Find checkmate in one. Explain the same geometry from the opposite orientation.

DIFFICULTY

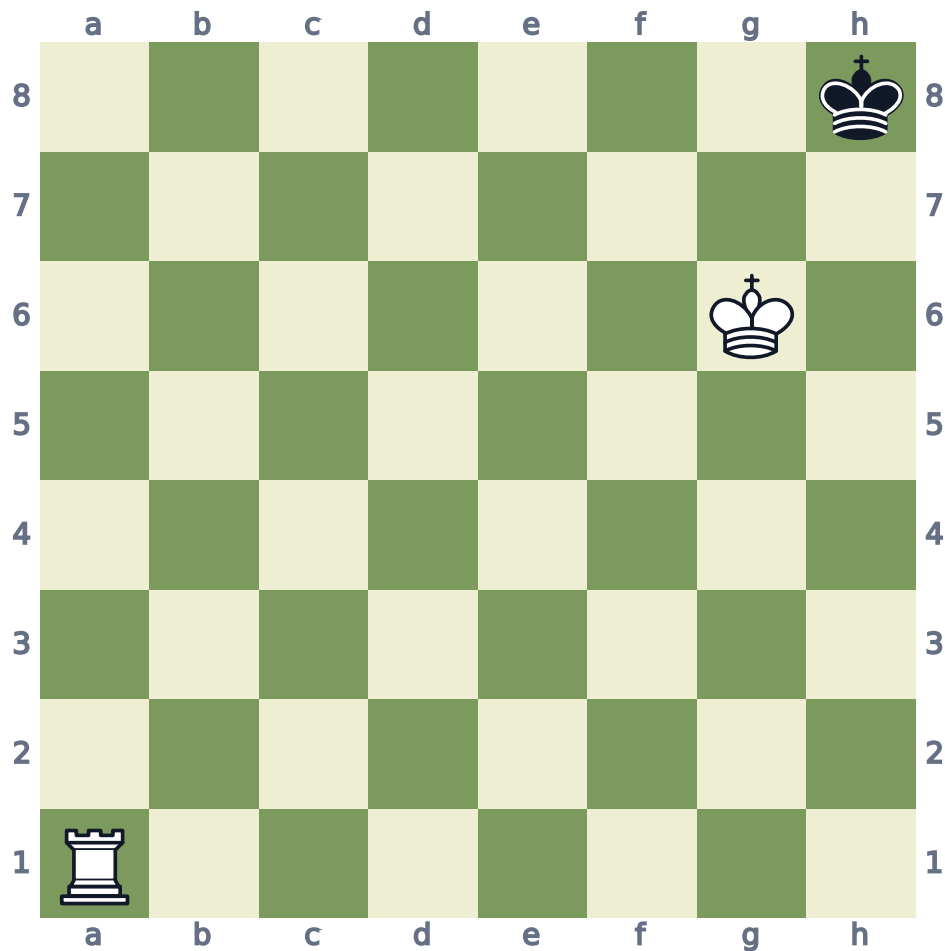
Foundation - reverse view

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 13 OF 24

Rook box mate



YOUR TASK

White to move. Find checkmate in one and name every escape square that is controlled or occupied.

DIFFICULTY

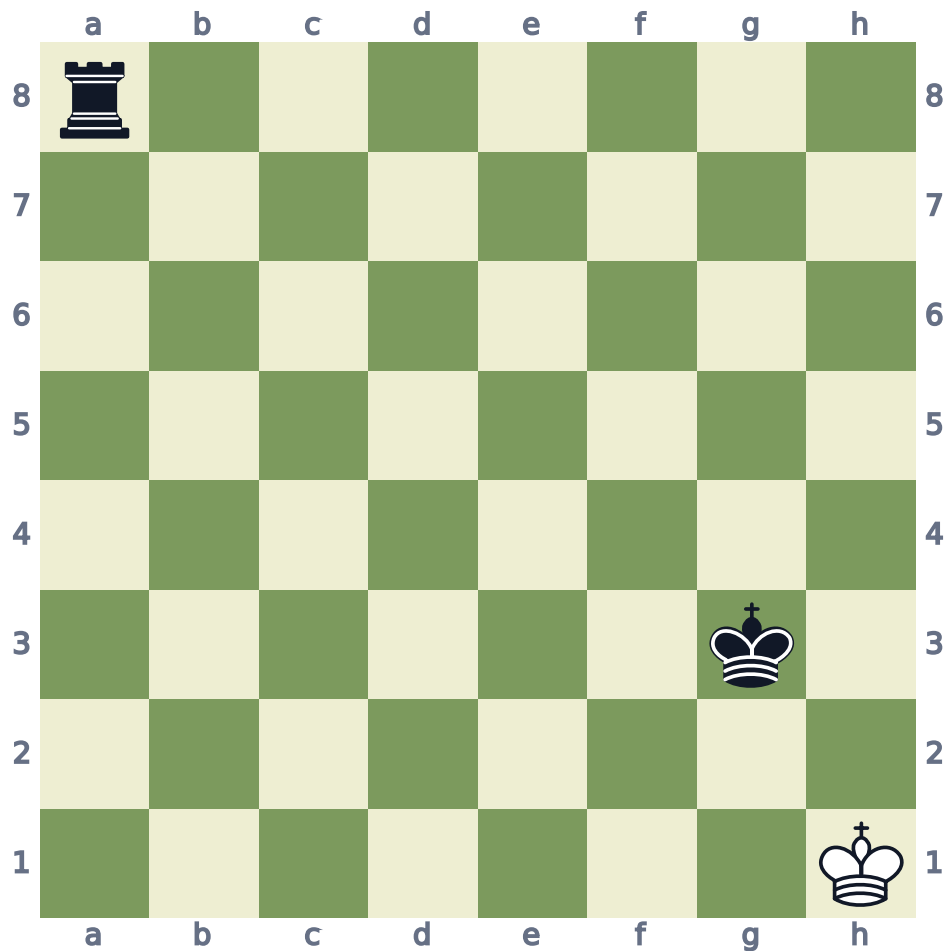
Foundation

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 14 OF 24

Rook box mate - reversed colors



YOUR TASK

Black to move. Find checkmate in one. Explain the same geometry from the opposite orientation.

DIFFICULTY

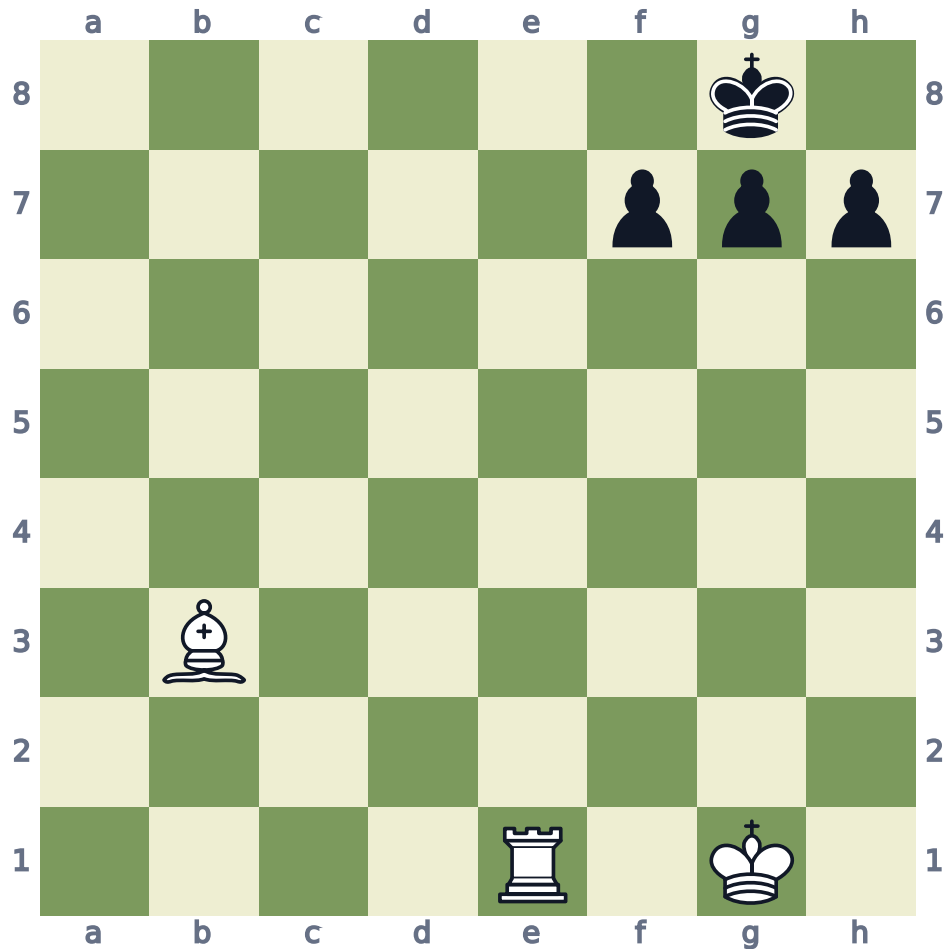
Foundation - reverse view

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 15 OF 24

Rook-and-bishop back rank



YOUR TASK

White to move. Find checkmate in one and name every escape square that is controlled or occupied.

DIFFICULTY

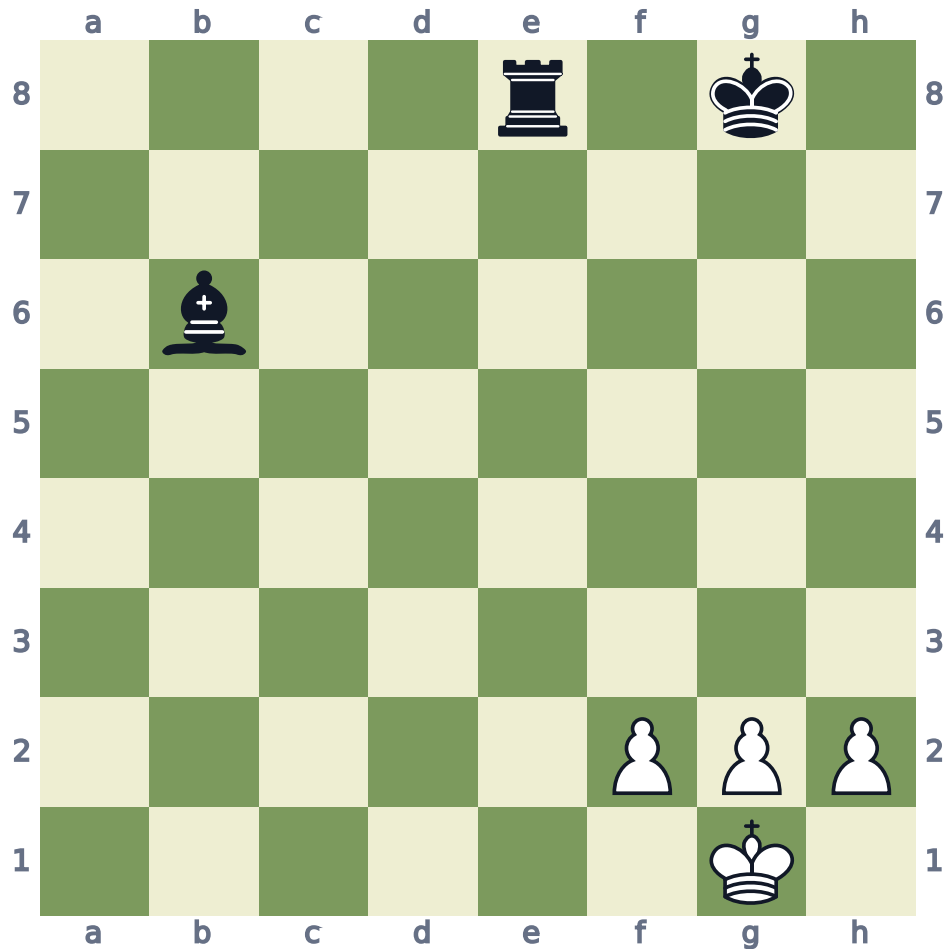
Foundation

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 16 OF 24

Rook-and-bishop back rank - reversed colors



YOUR TASK

Black to move. Find checkmate in one. Explain the same geometry from the opposite orientation.

DIFFICULTY

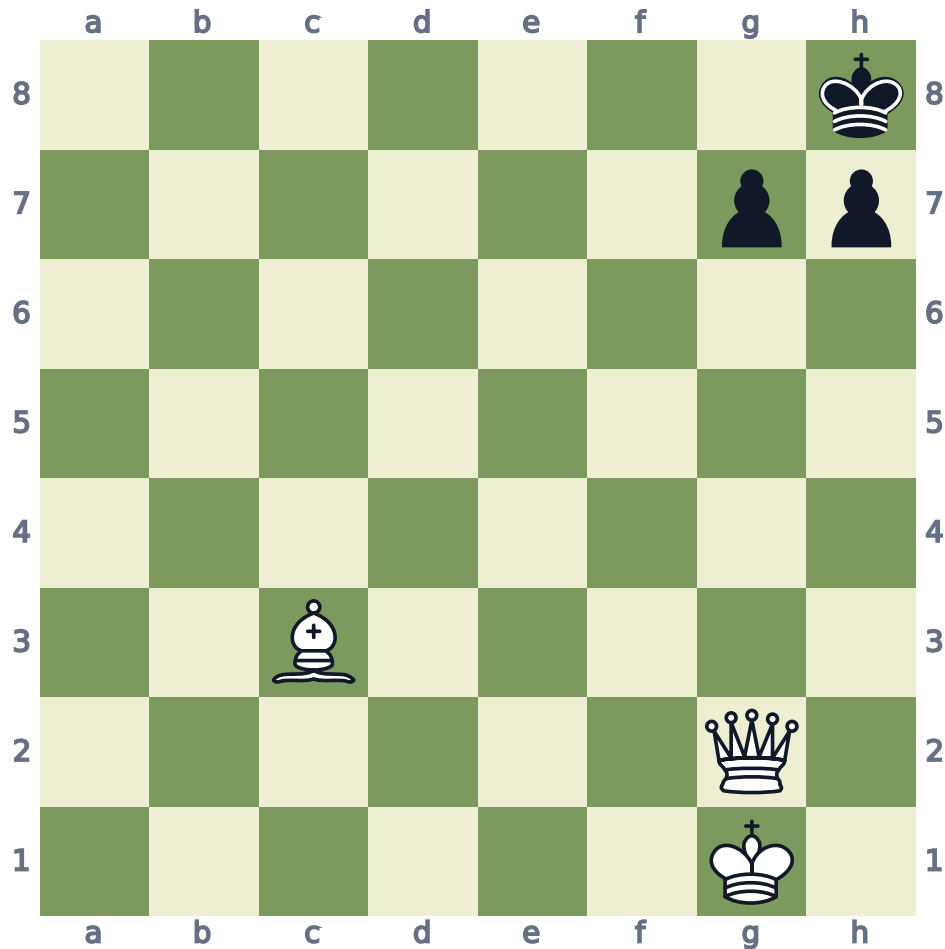
Foundation - reverse view

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 17 OF 24

Queen-and-bishop battery



YOUR TASK

White to move. Find checkmate in one and name every escape square that is controlled or occupied.

DIFFICULTY

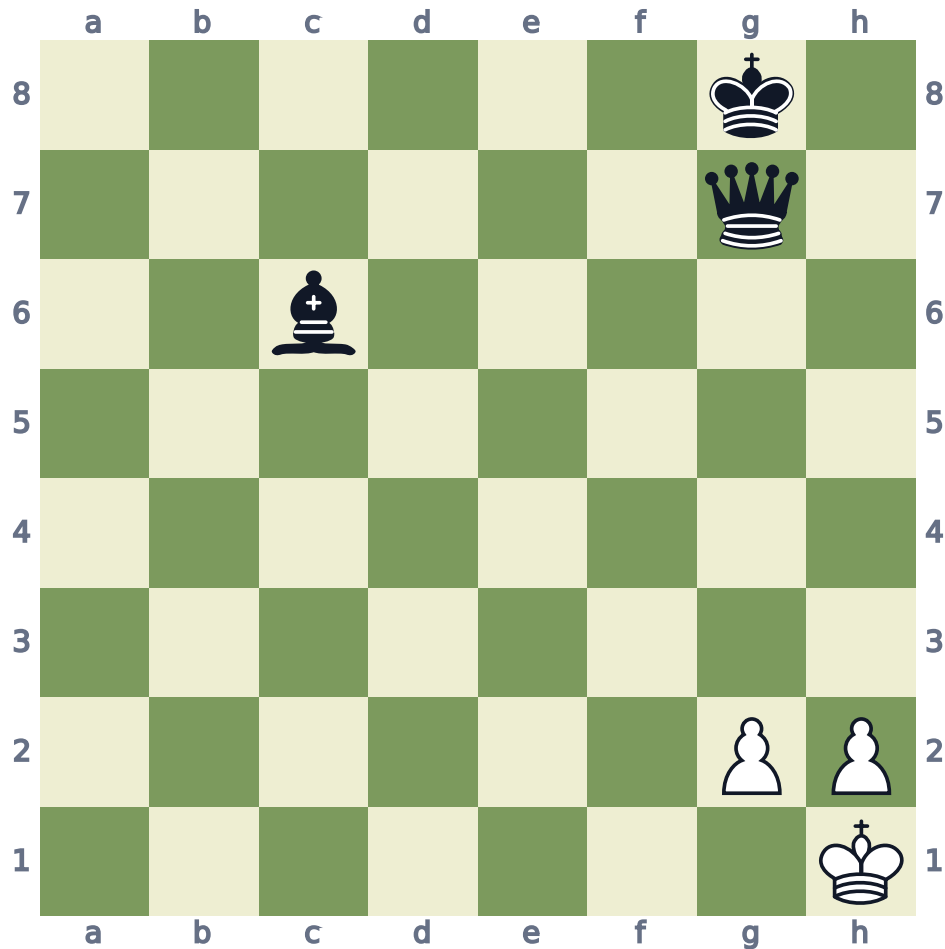
Foundation

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 18 OF 24

Queen-and-bishop battery - reversed colors



YOUR TASK

Black to move. Find checkmate in one. Explain the same geometry from the opposite orientation.

DIFFICULTY

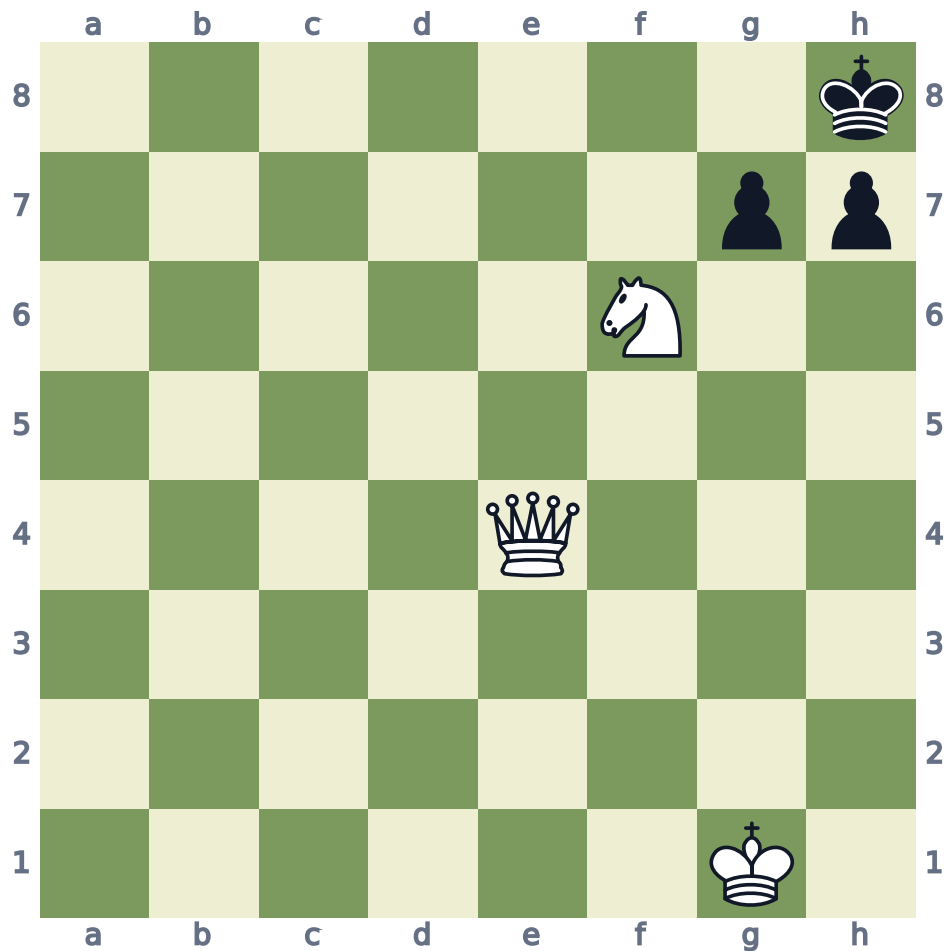
Foundation - reverse view

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 19 OF 24

Queen-and-knight mate



YOUR TASK

White to move. Find checkmate in one and name every escape square that is controlled or occupied.

DIFFICULTY

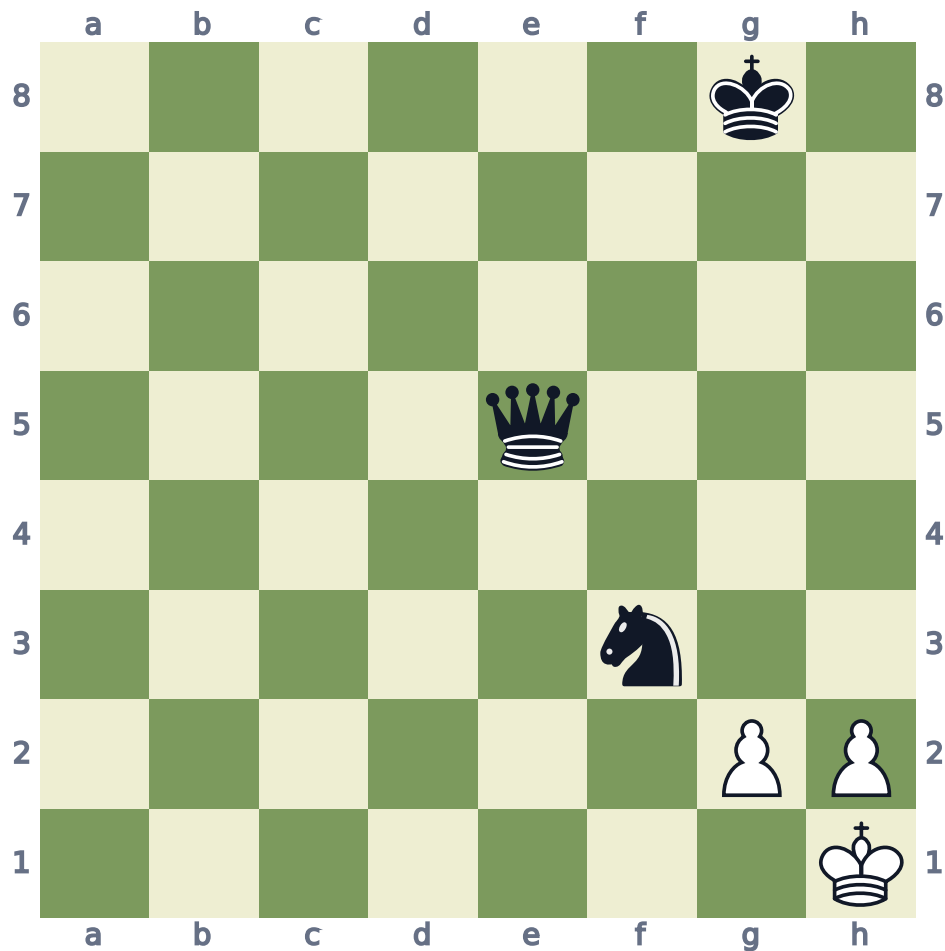
Foundation

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 20 OF 24

Queen-and-knight mate - reversed colors



YOUR TASK

Black to move. Find checkmate in one. Explain the same geometry from the opposite orientation.

DIFFICULTY

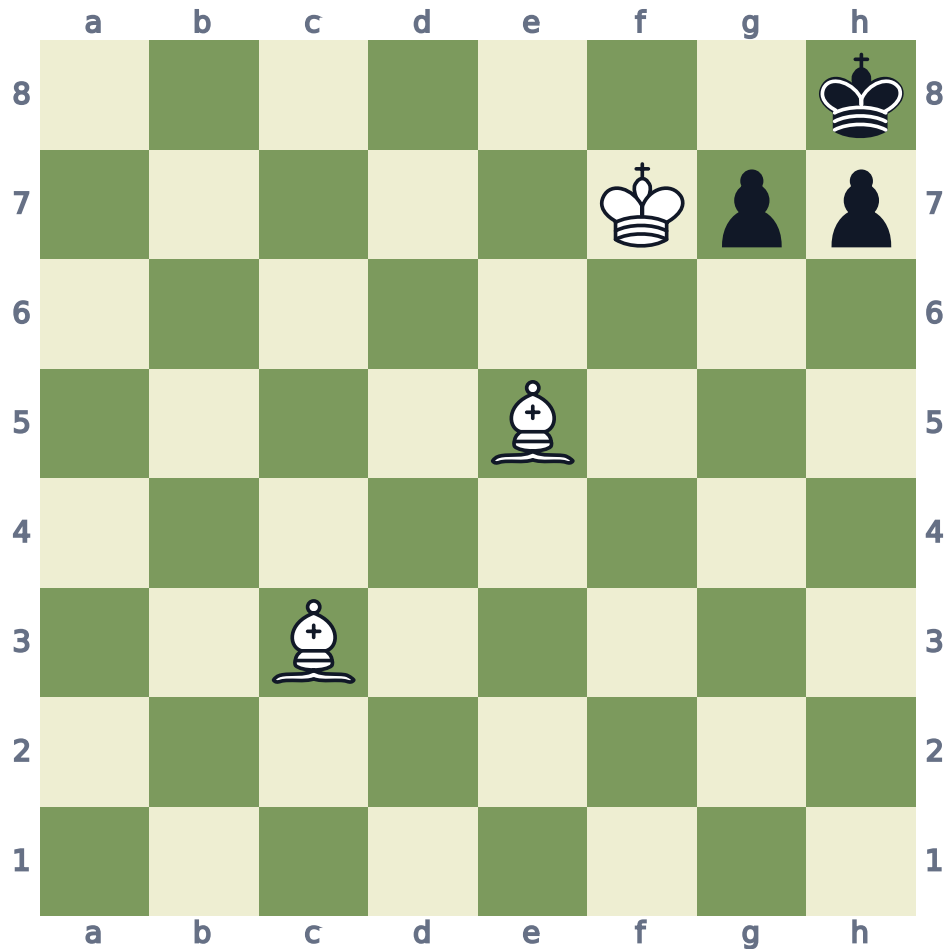
Foundation - reverse view

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 21 OF 24

Double-bishop mate

**YOUR TASK**

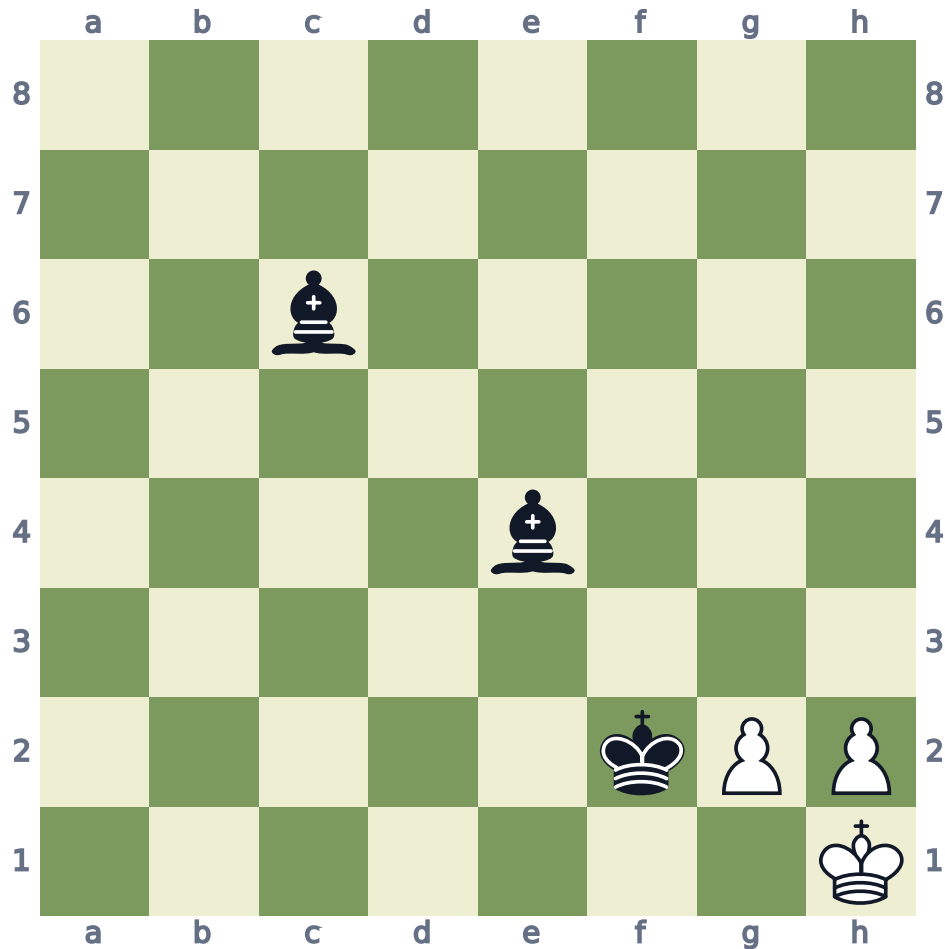
White to move. Find checkmate in one and name every escape square that is controlled or occupied.

DIFFICULTY**Foundation****BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION**

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 22 OF 24

Double-bishop mate - reversed colors



YOUR TASK

Black to move. Find checkmate in one. Explain the same geometry from the opposite orientation.

DIFFICULTY

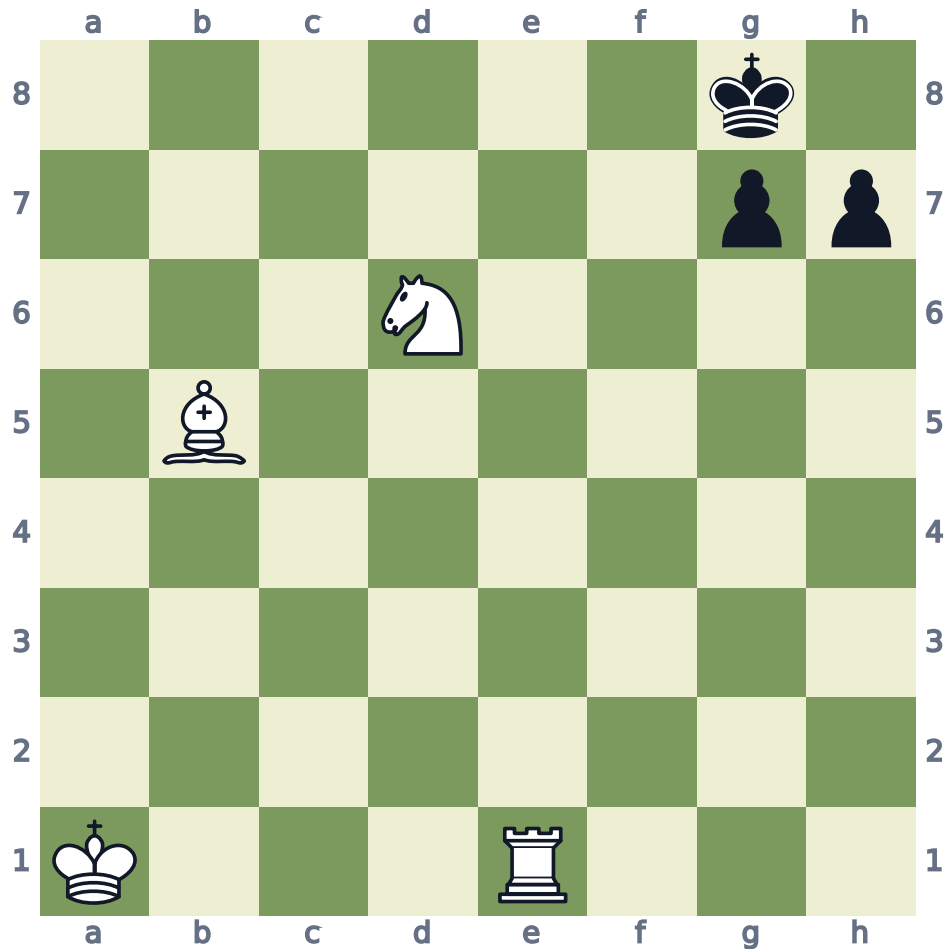
Foundation - reverse view

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 23 OF 24

Rook-and-bishop corridor



YOUR TASK

White to move. Find checkmate in one and name every escape square that is controlled or occupied.

DIFFICULTY

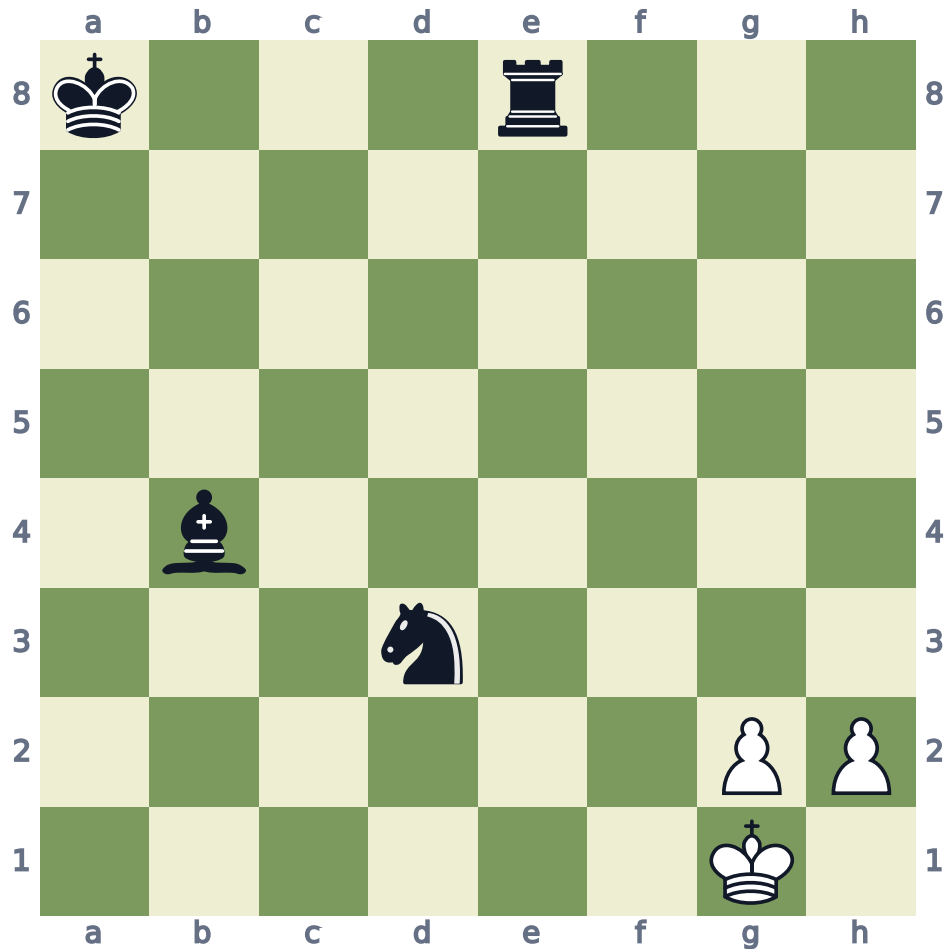
Foundation

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 24 OF 24

Rook-and-bishop corridor - reversed colors



YOUR TASK

Black to move. Find checkmate in one. Explain the same geometry from the opposite orientation.

DIFFICULTY

Foundation - reverse view

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

ANSWER SECTION

Solutions begin on the next page

PROTECT THE TRAINING EFFECT

Do not browse the solution pages casually. Return to each problem, reconstruct the position, and compare the entire decision process. If your move matches but your line omits the best defense, score it as incomplete.

ERROR LABELS

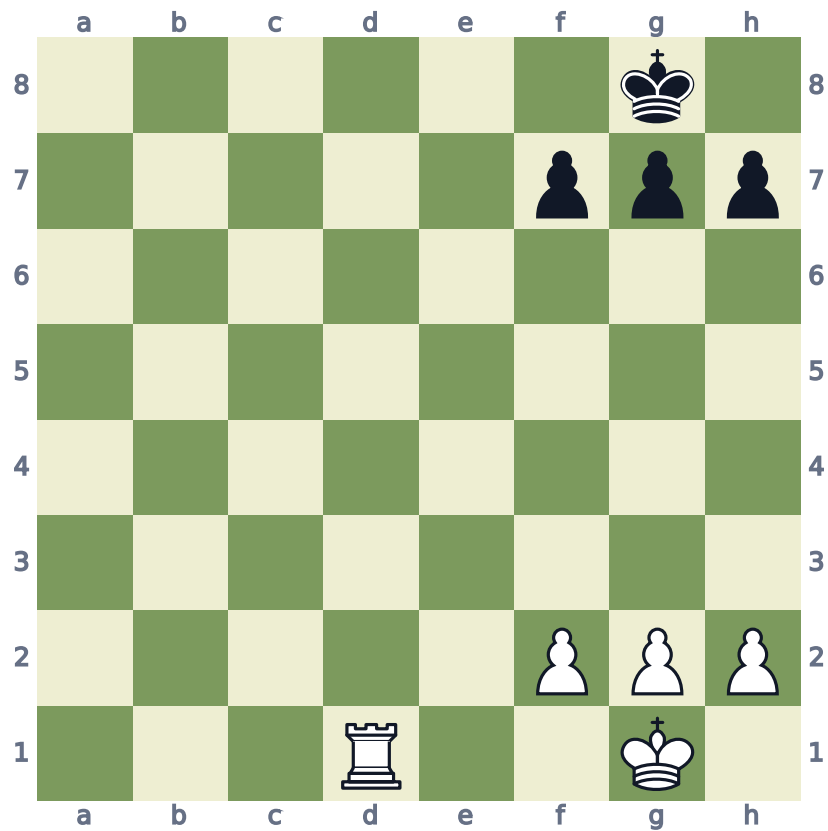
R = recognition error | C = candidate error | V = visualization error | D = missed defense | E = endpoint evaluation error | T = time-management error

REPAIR RULE

Every miss must produce one replacement question. Example: 'Before I calculate my attack, what countercheck does the opponent have?' Use that question in the next five slow games.

SOLUTION 01 OF 24

Back-rank mate

**VERIFIED LINE**

Rd8#

WHY IT WORKS

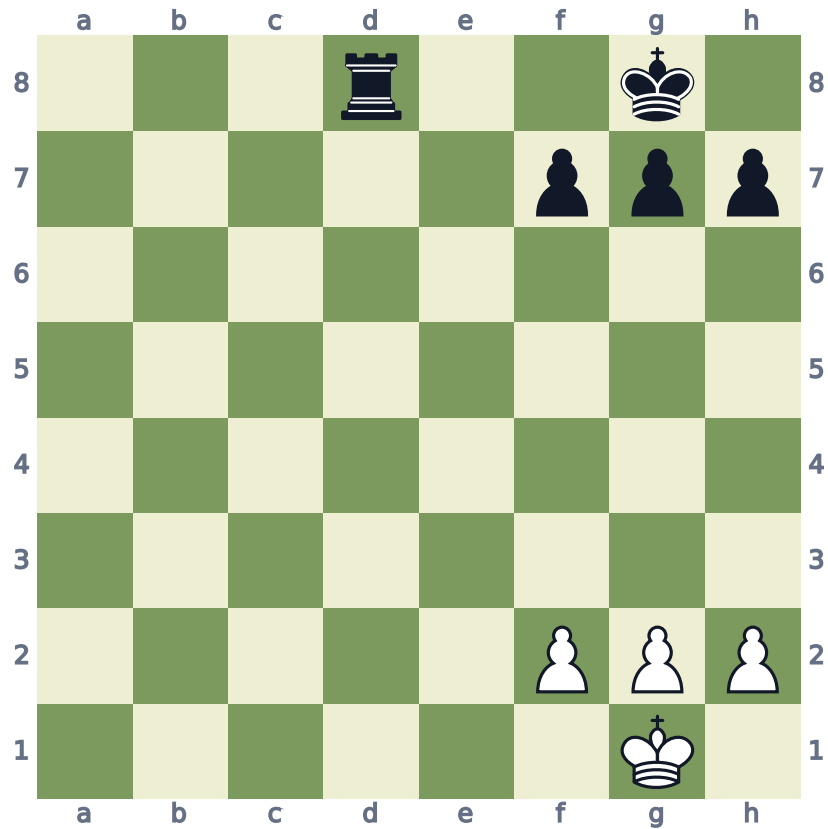
The rook enters the back rank while the king's own pawns remove every flight square.

SCORING

1 move, 2 geometry, 1 verbal explanation = 4 points Engine assessment: forced checkmate or exact construction.

SOLUTION 02 OF 24

Back-rank mate - reversed colors



VERIFIED LINE

Rd1#

WHY IT WORKS

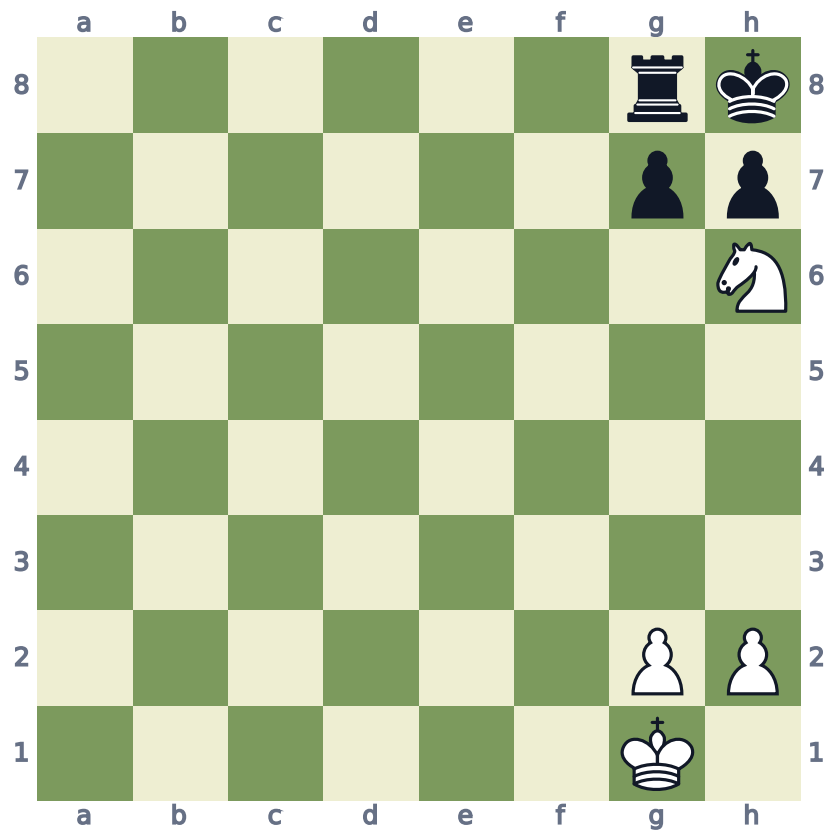
The rook enters the back rank while the king's own pawns remove every flight square.

SCORING

1 move, 2 geometry, 1 verbal explanation = 4 points Engine assessment: forced checkmate or exact construction.

SOLUTION 03 OF 24

Smothered mate



VERIFIED LINE

Nf7#

WHY IT WORKS

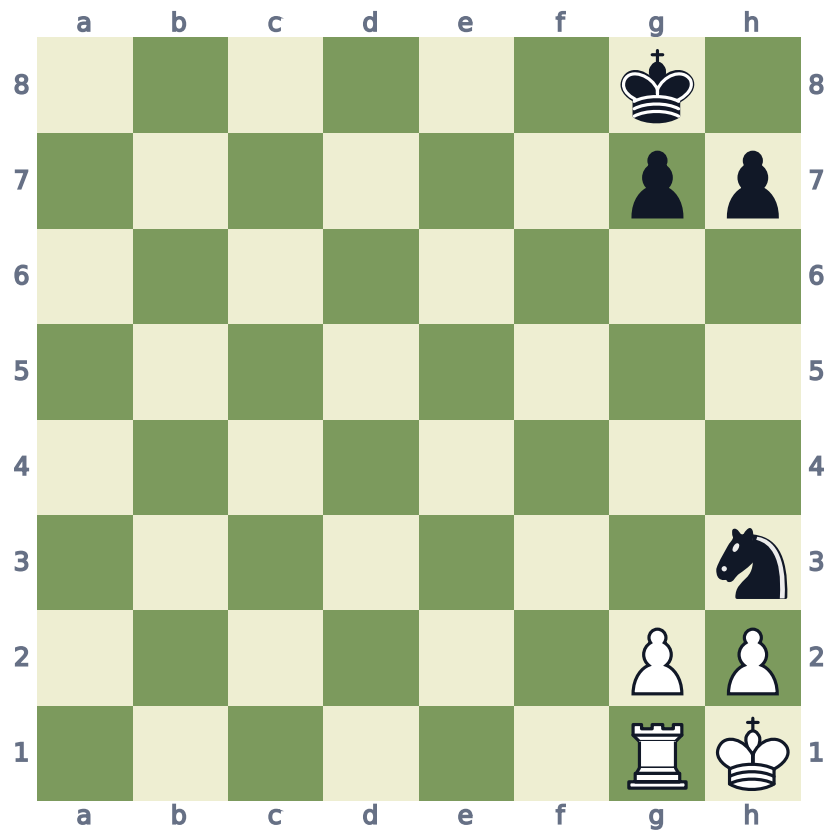
The knight checks a king completely enclosed by its own rook and pawns.

SCORING

1 move, 2 geometry, 1 verbal explanation = 4 points Engine assessment: forced checkmate or exact construction.

SOLUTION 04 OF 24

Smothered mate - reversed colors



VERIFIED LINE

Nf2#

WHY IT WORKS

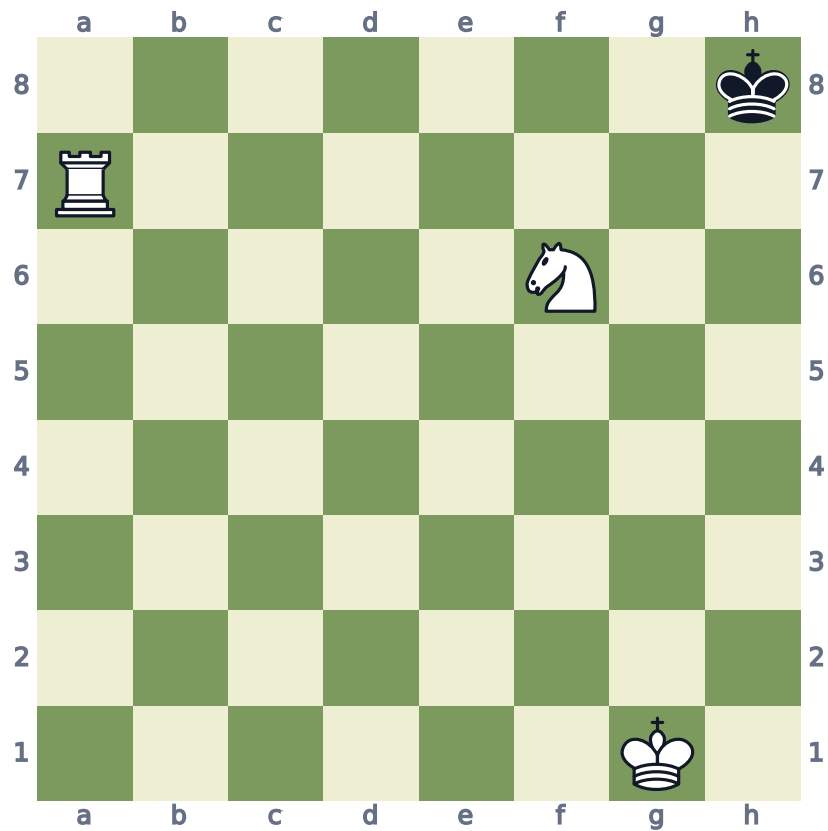
The knight checks a king completely enclosed by its own rook and pawns.

SCORING

1 move, 2 geometry, 1 verbal explanation = 4 points Engine assessment: forced checkmate or exact construction.

SOLUTION 05 OF 24

Arabic mate

**VERIFIED LINE**

Rh7#

WHY IT WORKS

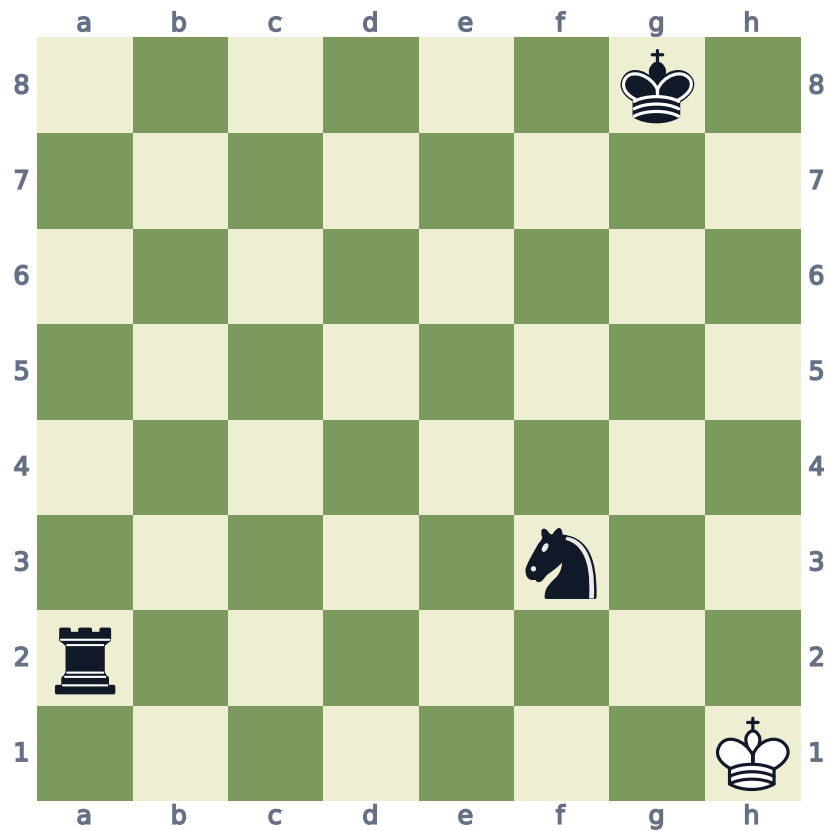
The rook checks from the adjacent file while the knight protects the rook and covers the escape square.

SCORING

1 move, 2 geometry, 1 verbal explanation = 4 points Engine assessment: forced checkmate or exact construction.

SOLUTION 06 OF 24

Arabian mate - reversed colors

**VERIFIED LINE**

Rh2#

WHY IT WORKS

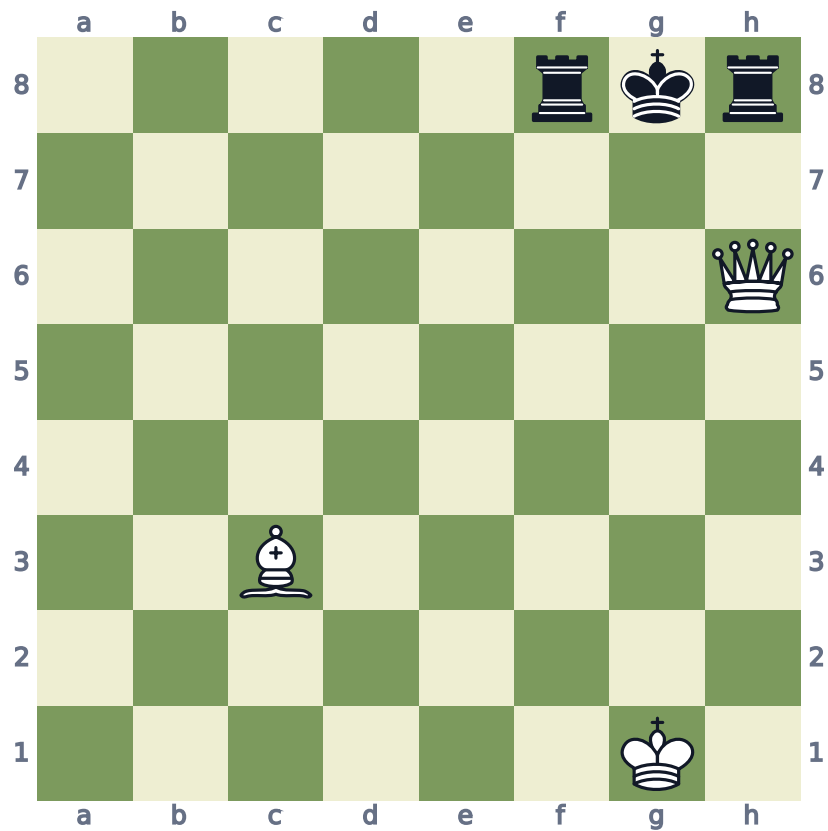
The rook checks from the adjacent file while the knight protects the rook and covers the escape square.

SCORING

1 move, 2 geometry, 1 verbal explanation = 4 points Engine assessment: forced checkmate or exact construction.

SOLUTION 07 OF 24

Epaulette mate



VERIFIED LINE

Qg7#

WHY IT WORKS

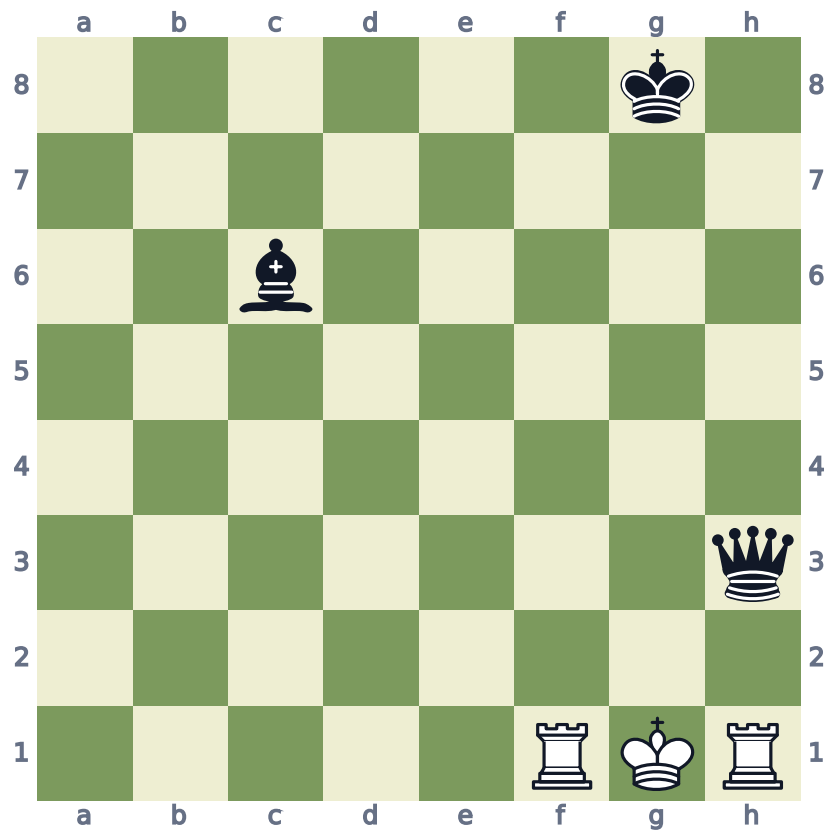
The king's own rooks form the epaulettes; the queen checks from close range and the bishop protects it.

SCORING

1 move, 2 geometry, 1 verbal explanation = 4 points Engine assessment: forced checkmate or exact construction.

SOLUTION 08 OF 24

Epaulette mate - reversed colors



VERIFIED LINE

Qg2#

WHY IT WORKS

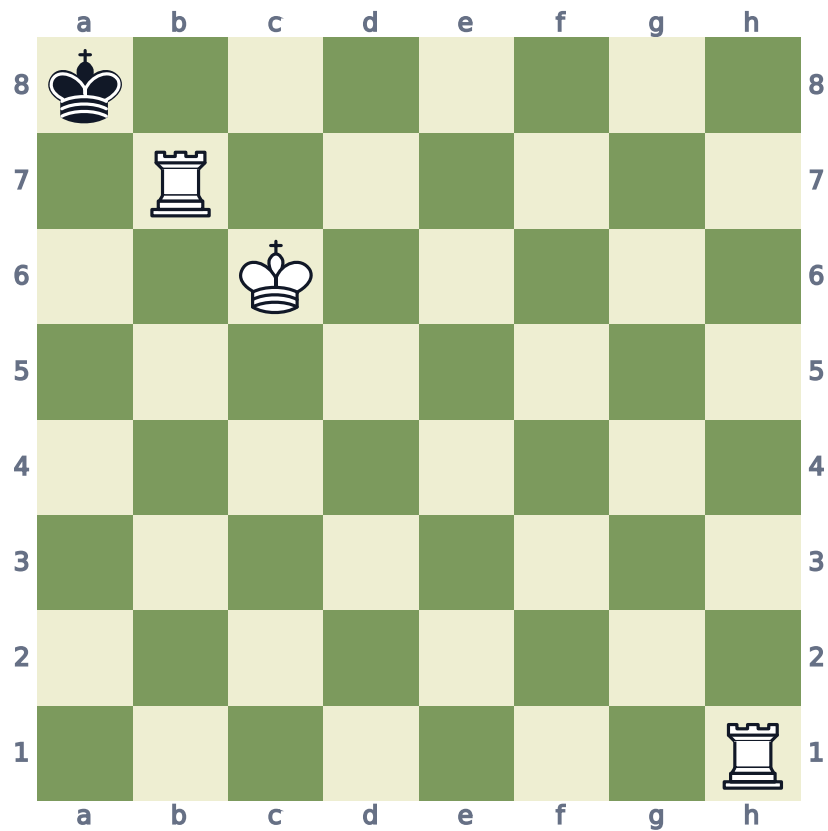
The king's own rooks form the epaulettes; the queen checks from close range and the bishop protects it.

SCORING

1 move, 2 geometry, 1 verbal explanation = 4 points Engine assessment: forced checkmate or exact construction.

SOLUTION 09 OF 24

Ladder mate

**VERIFIED LINE**

Rh8#

WHY IT WORKS

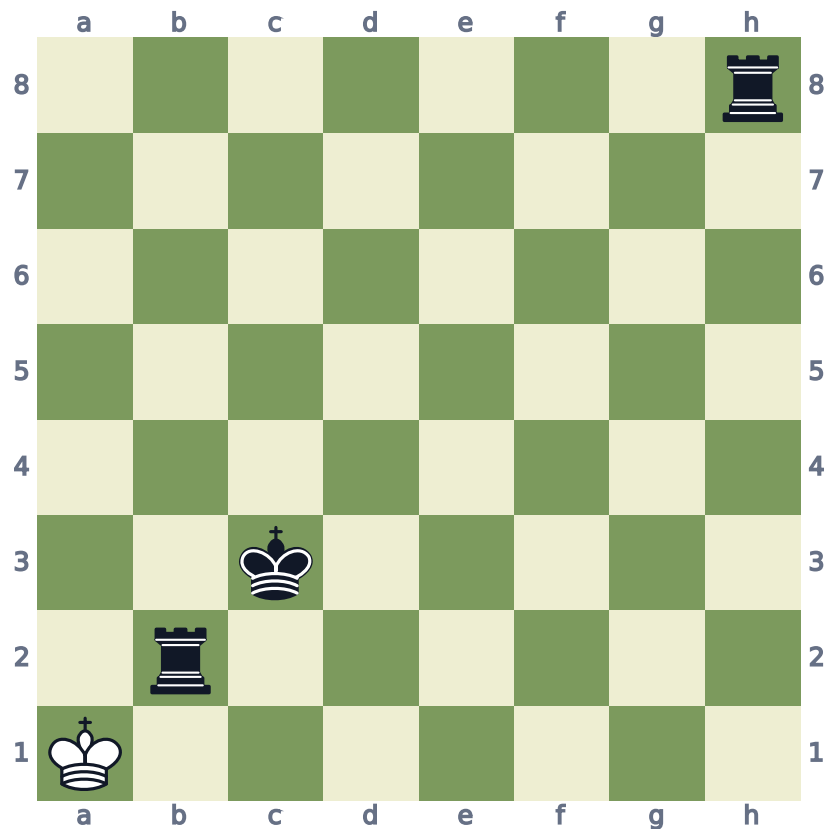
One rook gives the checking wall while the second rook seals the rank below it.

SCORING

1 move, 2 geometry, 1 verbal explanation = 4 points Engine assessment: forced checkmate or exact construction.

SOLUTION 10 OF 24

Ladder mate - reversed colors



VERIFIED LINE

Rh1#

WHY IT WORKS

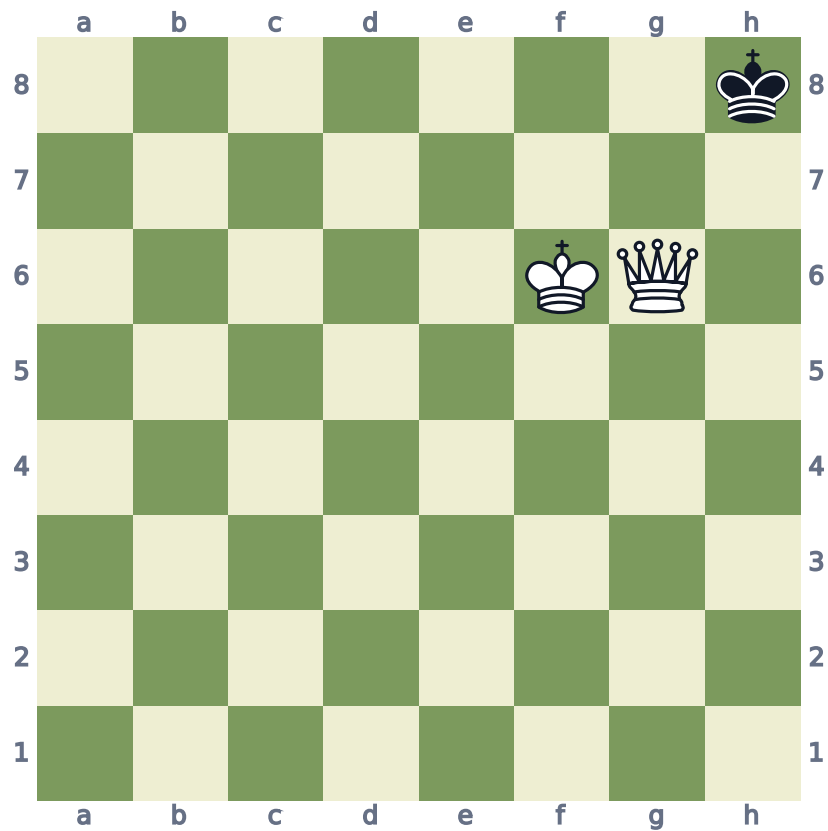
One rook gives the checking wall while the second rook seals the rank below it.

SCORING

1 move, 2 geometry, 1 verbal explanation = 4 points Engine assessment: forced checkmate or exact construction.

SOLUTION 11 OF 24

Queen box mate

**VERIFIED LINE**

Qg7#

WHY IT WORKS

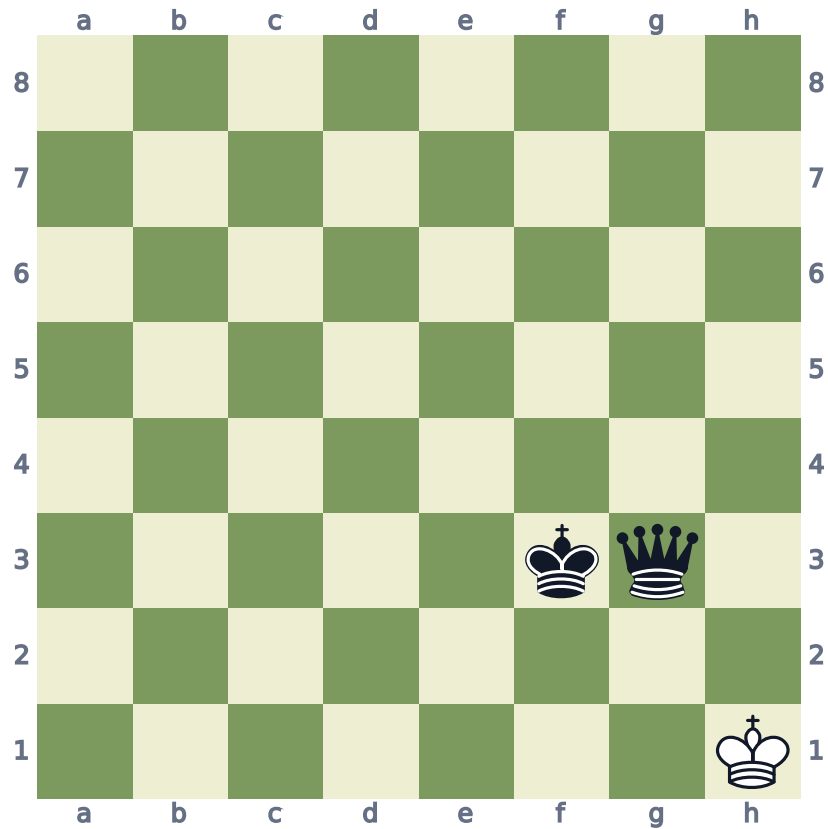
The queen removes the final squares while the king protects the queen.

SCORING

1 move, 2 geometry, 1 verbal explanation = 4 points Engine assessment: forced checkmate or exact construction.

SOLUTION 12 OF 24

Queen box mate - reversed colors



VERIFIED LINE

Qg2#

WHY IT WORKS

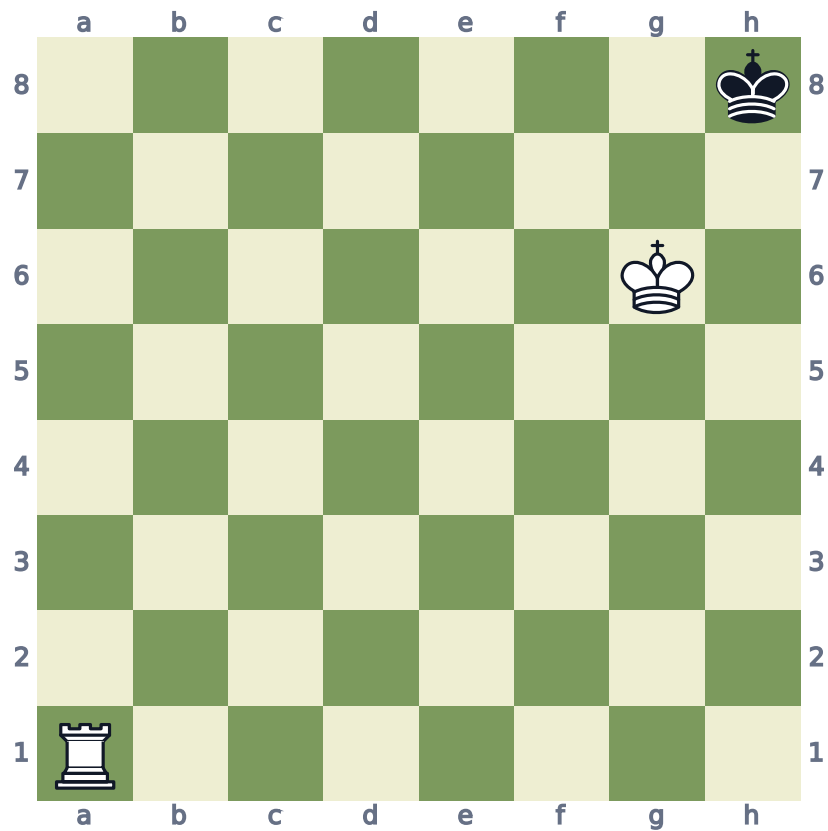
The queen removes the final squares while the king protects the queen.

SCORING

1 move, 2 geometry, 1 verbal explanation = 4 points Engine assessment: forced checkmate or exact construction.

SOLUTION 13 OF 24

Rook box mate

**VERIFIED LINE**

Ra8#

WHY IT WORKS

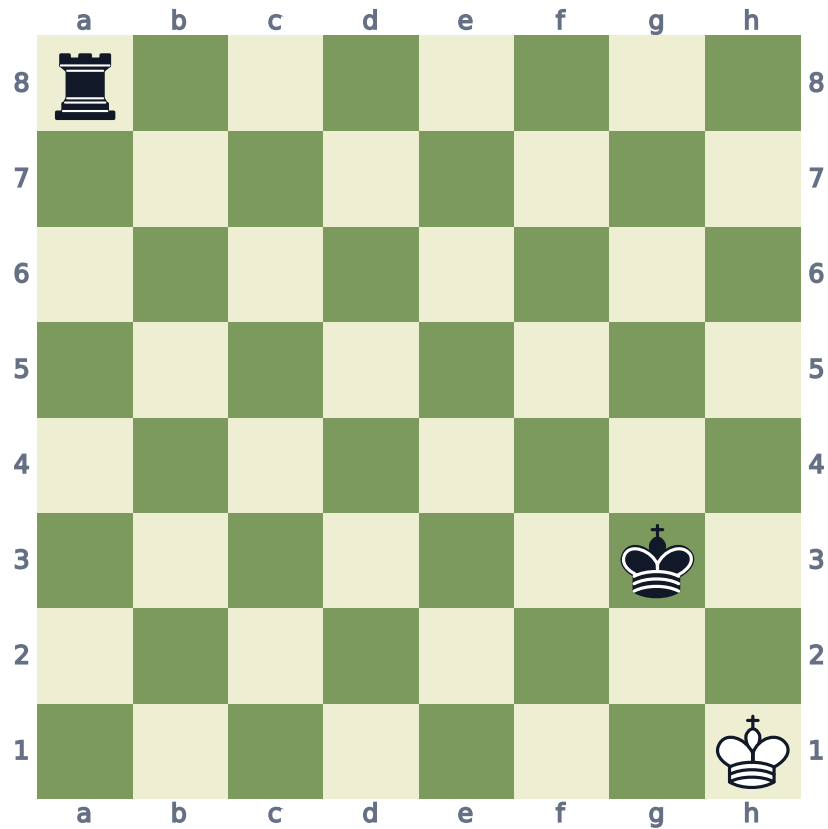
The rook checks across the back rank while the king closes both escape squares.

SCORING

1 move, 2 geometry, 1 verbal explanation = 4 points Engine assessment: forced checkmate or exact construction.

SOLUTION 14 OF 24

Rook box mate - reversed colors

**VERIFIED LINE**

Ra1#

WHY IT WORKS

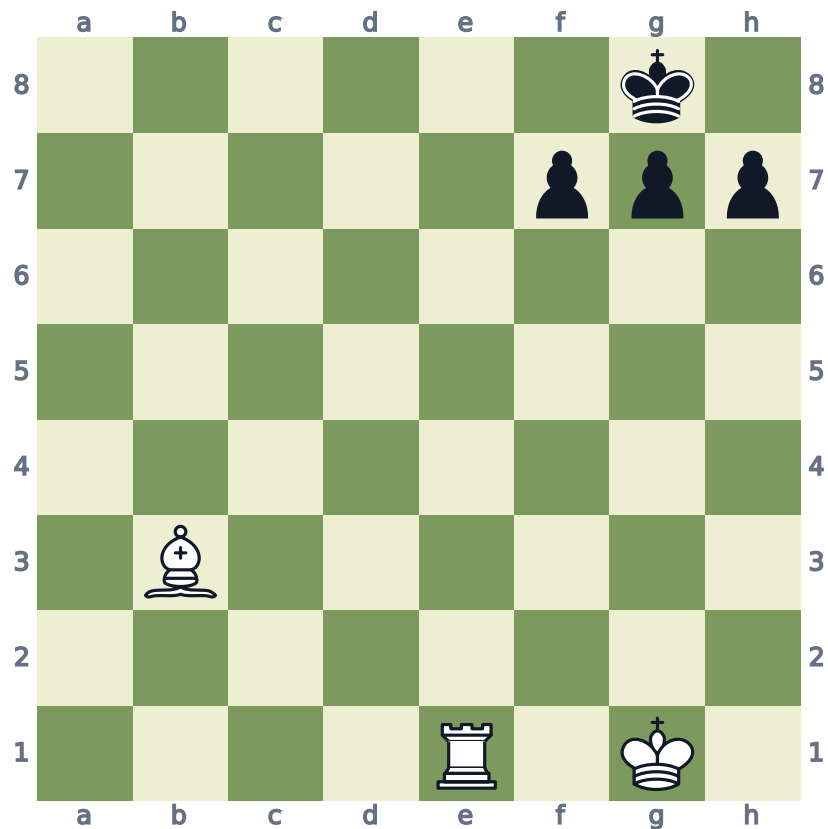
The rook checks across the back rank while the king closes both escape squares.

SCORING

1 move, 2 geometry, 1 verbal explanation = 4 points Engine assessment: forced checkmate or exact construction.

SOLUTION 15 OF 24

Rook-and-bishop back rank



VERIFIED LINE

Re8#

WHY IT WORKS

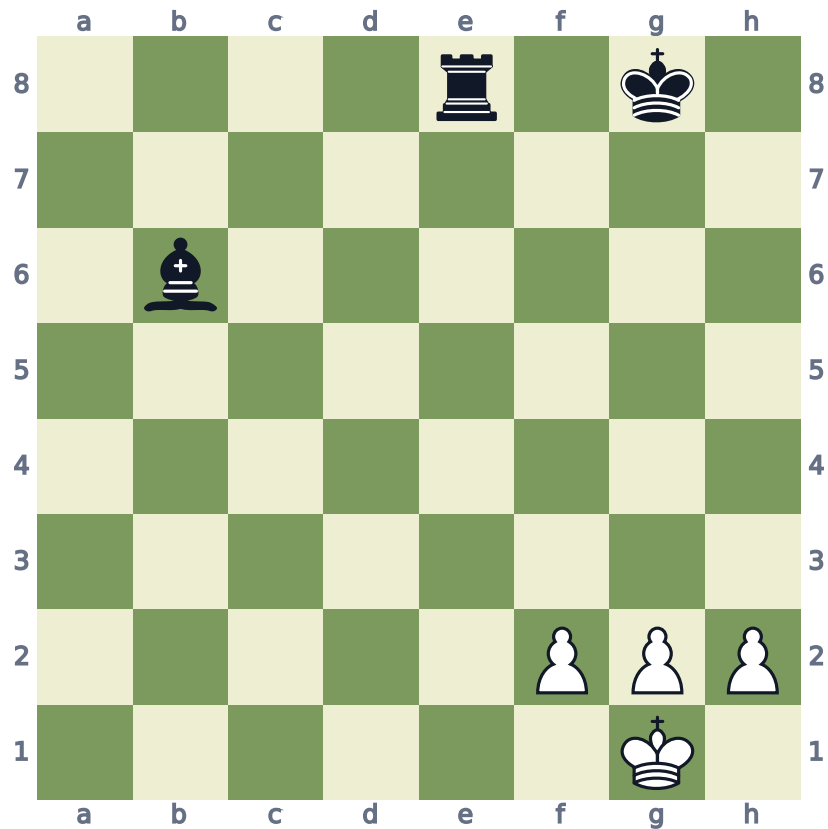
The rook controls the rank while the bishop covers the king's diagonal escape.

SCORING

1 move, 2 geometry, 1 verbal explanation = 4 points Engine assessment: forced checkmate or exact construction.

SOLUTION 16 OF 24

Rook-and-bishop back rank - reversed colors

**VERIFIED LINE**

Re1#

WHY IT WORKS

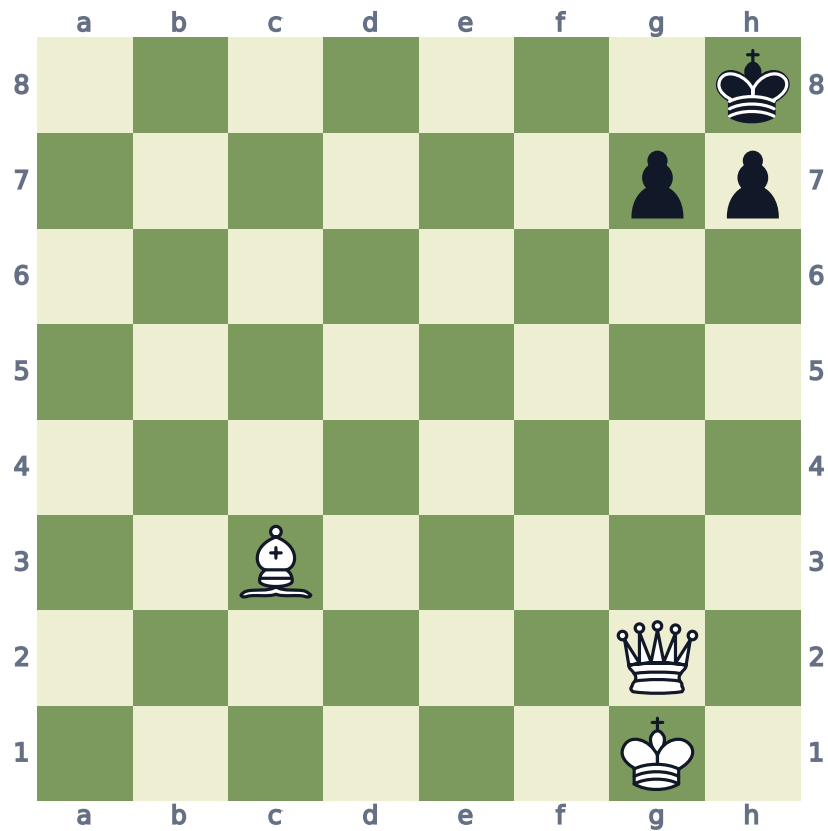
The rook controls the rank while the bishop covers the king's diagonal escape.

SCORING

1 move, 2 geometry, 1 verbal explanation = 4 points Engine assessment: forced checkmate or exact construction.

SOLUTION 17 OF 24

Queen-and-bishop battery



VERIFIED LINE

Qxg7#

WHY IT WORKS

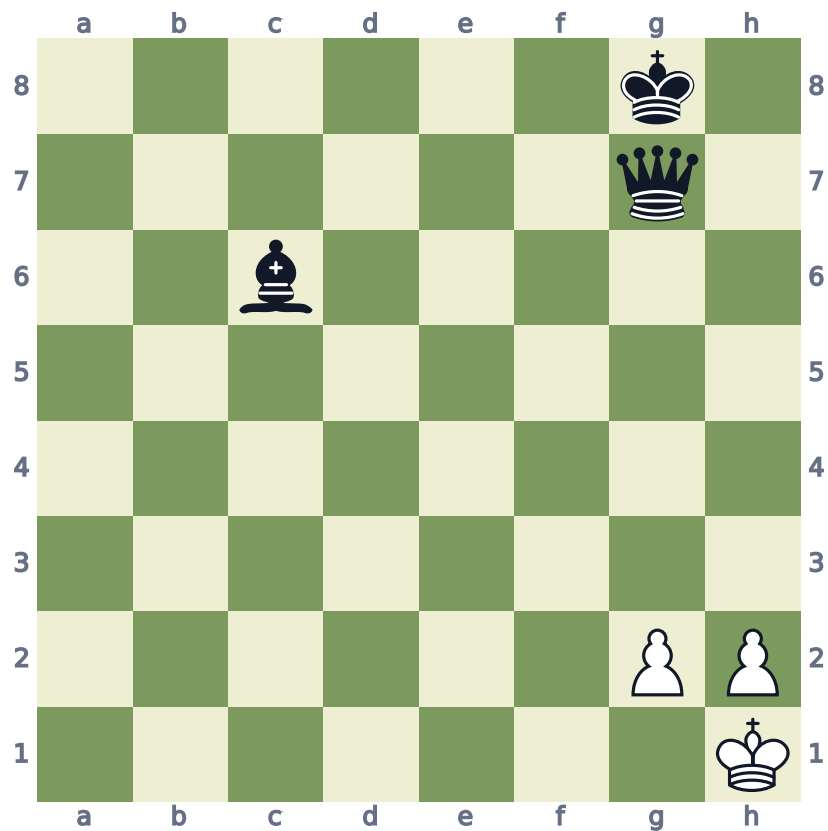
The queen arrives beside the king and the distant bishop protects the capture square.

SCORING

1 move, 2 geometry, 1 verbal explanation = 4 points Engine assessment: forced checkmate or exact construction.

SOLUTION 18 OF 24

Queen-and-bishop battery - reversed colors

**VERIFIED LINE**

Qxg2#

WHY IT WORKS

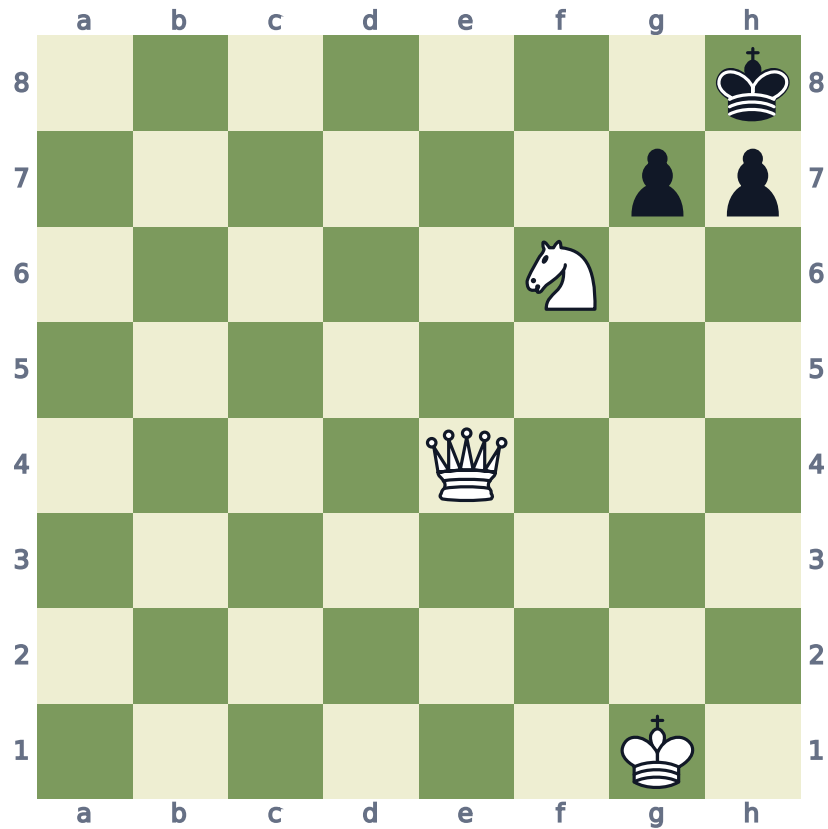
The queen arrives beside the king and the distant bishop protects the capture square.

SCORING

1 move, 2 geometry, 1 verbal explanation = 4 points Engine assessment: forced checkmate or exact construction.

SOLUTION 19 OF 24

Queen-and-knight mate

**VERIFIED LINE**

Qxh7#

WHY IT WORKS

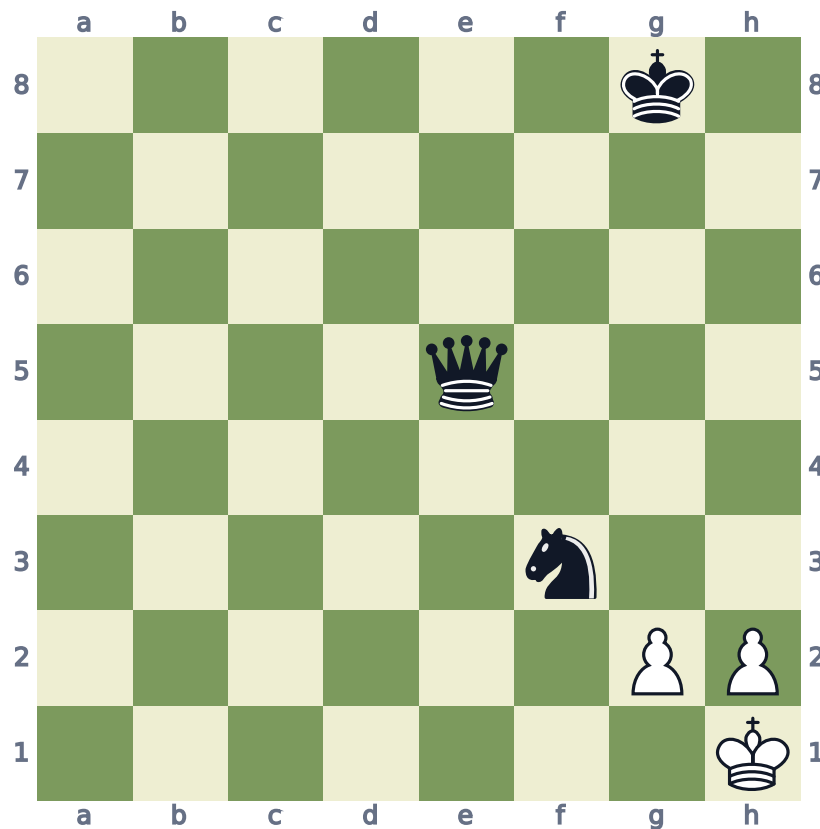
The knight protects the queen and covers the square the king most wants to use.

SCORING

1 move, 2 geometry, 1 verbal explanation = 4 points Engine assessment: forced checkmate or exact construction.

SOLUTION 20 OF 24

Queen-and-knight mate - reversed colors



VERIFIED LINE

Qxh2#

WHY IT WORKS

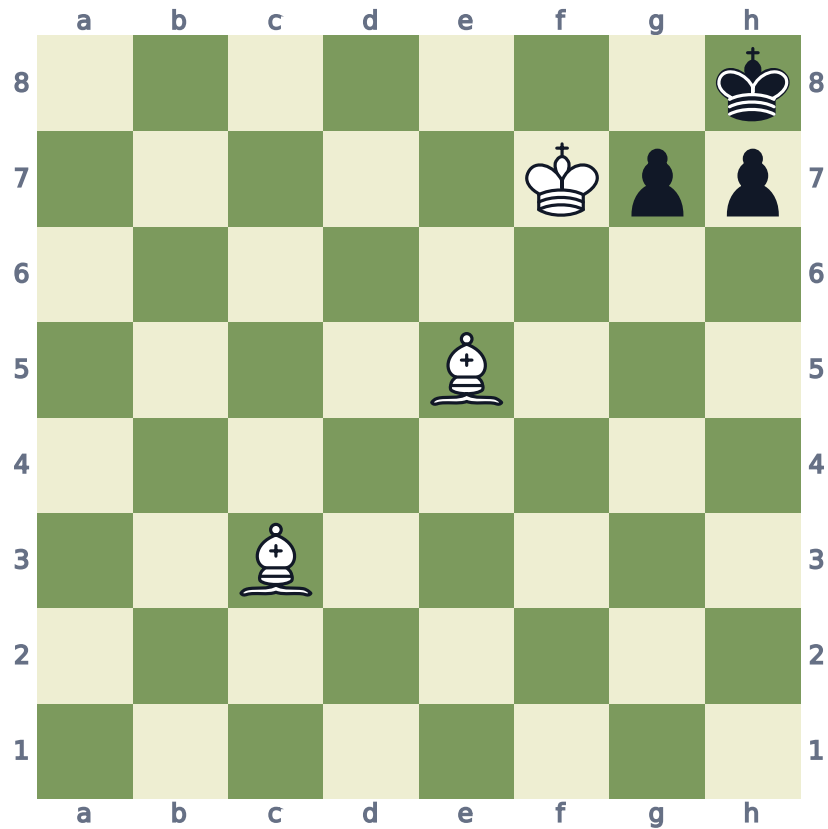
The knight protects the queen and covers the square the king most wants to use.

SCORING

1 move, 2 geometry, 1 verbal explanation = 4 points Engine assessment: forced checkmate or exact construction.

SOLUTION 21 OF 24

Double-bishop mate



VERIFIED LINE

Bxg7#

WHY IT WORKS

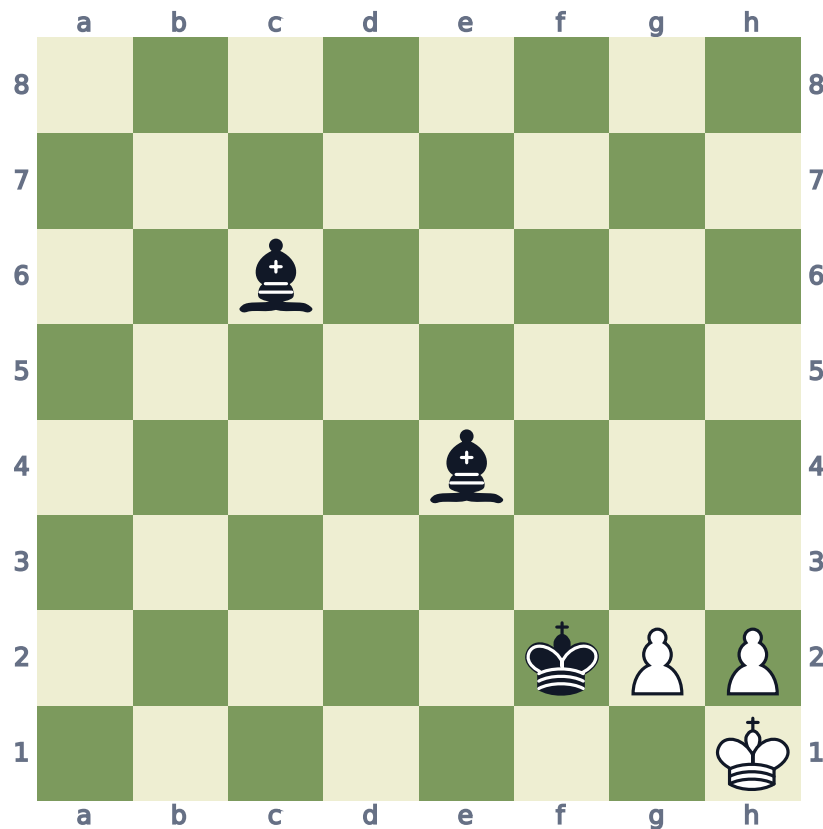
One bishop captures with check, the other protects it across the board, and the king closes g8.

SCORING

1 move, 2 geometry, 1 verbal explanation = 4 points Engine assessment: forced checkmate or exact construction.

SOLUTION 22 OF 24

Double-bishop mate - reversed colors

**VERIFIED LINE**

Bxg2#

WHY IT WORKS

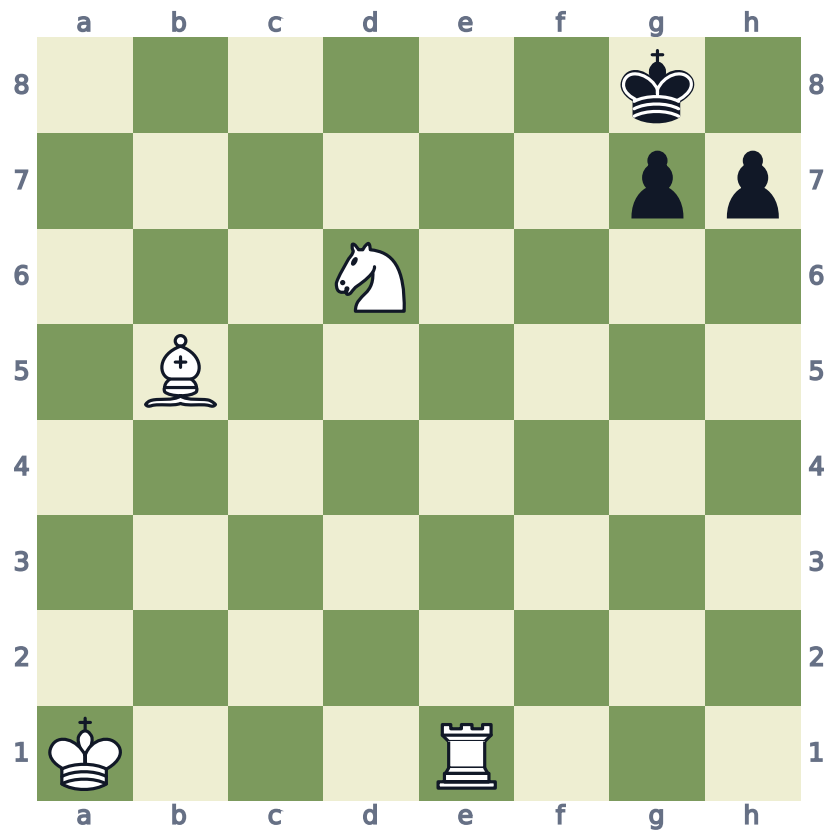
One bishop captures with check, the other protects it across the board, and the king closes g8.

SCORING

1 move, 2 geometry, 1 verbal explanation = 4 points Engine assessment: forced checkmate or exact construction.

SOLUTION 23 OF 24

Rook-and-bishop corridor



VERIFIED LINE

Re8#

WHY IT WORKS

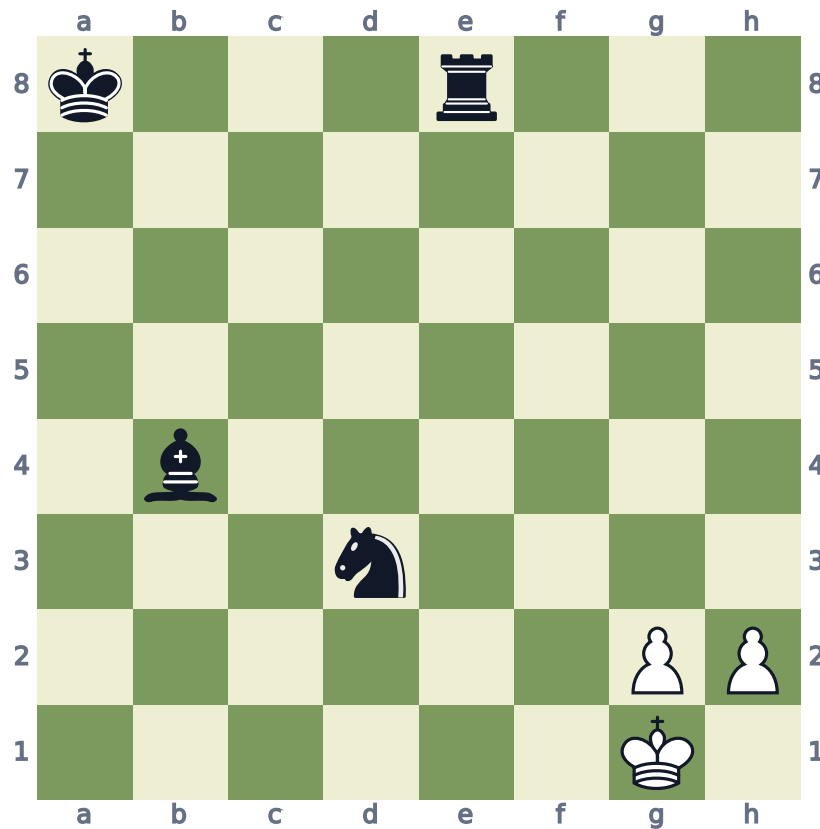
The rook seals the eighth rank, the knight closes f7, and the bishop supports the checking square.

SCORING

1 move, 2 geometry, 1 verbal explanation = 4 points Engine assessment: forced checkmate or exact construction.

SOLUTION 24 OF 24

Rook-and-bishop corridor - reversed colors



VERIFIED LINE

Re1#

WHY IT WORKS

The rook seals the eighth rank, the knight closes f7, and the bishop supports the checking square.

SCORING

1 move, 2 geometry, 1 verbal explanation = 4 points Engine assessment: forced checkmate or exact construction.

REVIEW

Final mixed review

1

Select five missed positions and solve them in random order without motif names.

2

Explain why the best defense fails in each of those positions.

3

Reverse the board and describe whether the same geometry is still easy to recognize.

4

Find one example of the theme in your own game or a Fritz training game.

5

Retest under a shorter clock only after calculation is accurate without time pressure.

RETRIEVAL SCHEDULE

Repeat missed positions tomorrow, then after 3, 7, 14, and 30 days. Remove a position only after two correct solutions with a complete explanation.